

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2001-04-21

To the b ahá'ís of the w orld

Ridván 2001

To the b ahá'ís of the w orld

dearly loved f riends,

with great joy in our hearts and high expectations, we come to this rixván

season at a change of time, when a new state of mind is evident among us

all. Abroad in our world community there is a heightened awareness of the value of process, the necessity of planning and the virtue of systematic

action in fostering growth and in developing the human resources by which expansion can be sustained and consolidation assured. The coherence of understanding about these prerequisites of progress cannot be overvalued, nor can the importance of perpetuating them through well-ordered training

be overestimated. And so the arrival of our community at such a moment

of consciousness is an occasion of significance for us. we are deeply grate-

ful to the blessed beauty to be able to recognize and acclaim it at the very

beginning of the global enterprise being launched during these festive days.

The power of will generated by this consciousness characterized the con-

ference of the continental counselors and the members of their Auxiliary

boards who gathered last january in the holy land. The event produced so

illuminating an experience as to signalize the faith's entry into a new epoch, .356.38a

357 .1

357 .2

m eS Sa g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

798the fifth of its formative Age. Such a freshness of vitality as was displayed

at this historic gathering came to be understood as a manifestation of the

rising quality of activity throughout the community. pursuit during the past

year of the essentials for advancing the process of entry by troops confirmed

this observation. The path was thus paved for the five year plan, the first

venture being entered upon in the f ifth e poch.

in augmenting major efforts of the previous four year plan that brought into being more than 300 training institutes, the T twelve month plan achieved its purpose. it gathered significance through the notable responses of institutions and individuals to the call for a greater focus on the spiritual nurturing of children and the involvement of junior youth in bahá'í community life. The training of teachers of children's classes and the inclusion of junior youth in the institute process have become a regular part of bahá'í activity in a number of countries. despite its brevity, the T twelve month plan had an importance beyond the objectives specifically assigned. The plan was a dynamic link between a highly eventful epoch in bahá'í history and the immensely promising prospects of a new one, for which its achievements have so well prepared the community. it has been etched in our annals, too, for the enduring effects of the faith's activities at the end of the twentieth century—a century that deserves to be reflected upon by any bahá'í who wishes to understand the tumultuous forces that influenced the life of the planet and the processes of the cause itself at a crucial time in humanity's social and spiritual evolution. As an aid to so worthy an effort, *Century of Light*, a review of the twentieth century, was prepared at our request and under our supervision.

on many occasions during this one-year endeavor, the external affairs activities of the faith were especially visible. consider, for example, the instances of bahá'í representatives' having participated prominently in the millennial events that took place in may, August and September at the urging of the Secretary-general of the united Nations. The implications of so close and conspicuous an involvement of the bahá'í international community with the processes of the lesser peace will require the passage of time to be properly understood. Among other highlights was the continental colloquium organized in india by the institute for Studies in global prosperity, a new agency operating under the aegis of the bahá'í international community. Adopting the theme of "science, religion and development," the conference featured the participation of leading non-governmental organizations of india, as well as that of institutions of such

357 .4

799renown as uNeSco, uNicef , who and the world bank. in october, the bahá'í world News Service (bwNS) was launched on the internet with the intention of reaching both bahá'í and non-b ahá'í audiences with news stories about developments throughout the b ahá'í world.

The intensive activities at the bahá'í world center during the last year were, for the most part, made known to the friends through previous reports that included references to such achievements as the occupation by the international Teaching center of its permanent seat on mount carmel; the conference of continental counselors and the members of their Auxiliary boards held in the holy land last january; and the completion of the mount carmel projects, which are now receiving finishing touches in preparation for the celebratory events in may. last october, for the first time, pilgrims and visitors were received at the new reception center in haifa, which became fully operational. At bahjí the embellishment of the sacred site through the development of its gardens has proceeded continually; the effort has, however, received a boost from the new project initiated last year to construct a visitors' center towards the northern end of the property beyond the collins gate. Scheduled for completion in the next few months, the structure is fully in place, and work is progressing in all areas, including finishing and landscaping. The new facilities will improve the ability of the world center to receive increasing numbers of pilgrims, short-term bahá'í visitors, and special guests.

To conclude this summary of the year, we rejoice in informing you that, after the lapse of almost three decades, the National Spiritual Assembly of the bahá'ís of indonesia was restored at the National convention held in jakarta last riṣván. A ban imposed on bahá'í activities in August 1962 severely restricted the actions of the indonesian bahá'ís for all that time, but they remained steadfast and wise in their long-suffering until changed circumstances in that country resulted in the lifting of the ban. may we not venture to hope, then, that a similar happy report concerning our beleaguered coreligionists in iran, egypt and other countries will not be too far distant?

dear friends: T wo decades from now the bahá'í world will celebrate the centenary of the inception of the formative Age. we look back at the dawning of the Age from the vantage point of attainments that could hardly have

been imagined at the outset. up ahead are horizons that urgently summon the community to even greater achievements in the short span separating it from that centennial. Those heights can and must be scaled. The five year 357 .5 357 .6

357 .7

m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

800plan, to which we call the urgent and sustained attention of the friends throughout the world, is intended to meet this challenge. it constitutes the first of a series of campaigns that will be pursued during these twenty years. This plan marks the next phase in the aim to accomplish a significant advance in the process of entry by troops. it demands an acceleration of this vital process and, furthermore, insists upon continuity in systematic endeavor on the part of its three constituent participants: the individual, the institutions, and the community.

No need to elaborate on the requirements of the plan, for these were set out in our message to the assembled counselors in the holy land and subsequently shared with all National Spiritual Assemblies. Soon after their conference, the counselors began consulting with the National Assemblies about the execution of the plan in their respective jurisdictions. The plan's

direction is therefore known to the friends everywhere, as regional and local preparations for pursuing its major aim are under way. There is a general awareness by now that efforts will be made to effect a deeper penetration of the faith into more and more regions within countries. for example, where

circumstances permit, local communities that exist in close proximity to each other will be mobilized to participate in intensive programs of growth. other approaches will require methodical opening of new areas for which

homefront pioneers must be raised up in the same consecrated spirit that prompted those who scattered abroad at earlier times to open virgin terri-

tories across continents and seas. Suffice it to say that the process animating this divinely driven enterprise will eventually expand as related features are

gradually introduced and systematically integrated into its operation.

A feature of the fifth epoch will be the enrichment of the devotional life of the community through the raising up of national houses of worship, the advancement of the process of entry by troops within countries. This development will unfold throughout successive stages of 'Abdu'l-b ahá's di-

vine plan. upon the completion of the mother Temple of the west, the guardian started a program of constructing continental temples. The first among these were the mashriqu'l-A dhkárs in kampala, Sydney and frankfurt, which were built in response to Ten year plan goals. The universal house of justice continued along these lines with the building of Temples in panama city, Apia, and New delhi. but this continental stage has yet to be completed: one more edifice remains to be built. it is with profound
357 .8
357 .9

2000–2001 • T h e T W e l v e m o n Th Pl a n

801thankfulness and joy that we announce at this auspicious moment the decision to proceed with this last project. during the five year plan, erection of the mother Temple of South America in Santiago, chile, will commence and thus fulfill a wish clearly expressed by Shoghi e ffendi.

meanwhile, the time is propitious that further steps be taken at the world center to develop the functions of the institutions occupying the new edifices on the Arc. The international Teaching center having advanced significantly in its work, attention will be given particularly to organizing the work of the center for the Study of the Texts. enriching the translations into english from the holy Texts will be a special object of this attention.

consulting the Sacred writings and to prepare translations and commentaries on the authoritative texts of the faith. moreover, in the holy land, a

continued effort will be devoted towards the devising of measures to make possible a further increase in the number of pilgrims and visitors to the bahá'í world center.

in our riṣván message five years ago, we announced the holding of a major event at the world center to mark the completion of the projects on mount carmel and the opening of the Terraces of the Shrine of the báb

to the public. The moment is upon us, and we exult in the anticipation of welcoming friends from virtually all countries to programs that will extend

over a five-day period, 21–25 may. we are also happy to say that steps are being taken to connect the bahá'í world to the proceedings through live transmissions on the world wide web and by satellite, about which information is being provided. As the world center focuses on the preparations, excitement is building up among the public in haifa, where municipal authorities have undertaken to publish a book entitled Bahá'í Shrine and

Gardens on Mount Carmel, Haifa, Israel: A Visual Journey to coincide with the event. moreover, the israel postal Authority is pursuing its decision to

release at the same time a commemorative stamp featuring the Terraces. The

significance of the occasion lies principally in the pause it will allow for a review of the remarkable distance the cause has covered in its development

during the twentieth century. it will be time, too, for considering the future

implications of the phenomenal accomplishments symbolized by the rise of the monumental structures on god's holy mountain—a rise that opens the

spiritual and administrative centers of our faith to the gaze of the world.

As our community rejoices in these thrilling considerations, let every

member bear in mind that there is no time for resting on laurels. human-357 .10

357 .11

357 .12

m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

802ity's current plight is too desperate to allow for even a moment's hesitation

in sharing the bread of life, which has come down from heaven in our time.

let there be no delay, then, in advancing the process that has every promise of success in ushering to the banquet table of the lord of hosts the souls of

all that hunger after truth.

may he who keeps watch over the destiny of his divine System guide

and direct and confirm every effort you make towards the realization of the urgent tasks set before you.

80glossary

Note: Boldface terms within entries are cross-references to other entries that define

or amplify essential terms. A number of entries are based on explanations found

in "definitions of Some of the oriental Terms used in bahá'í literature" in The

Bahá'í World: An International Record, Volume XVIII, 1979–1983, pp. 897–904. other entries are based on explanations found in the notes and glossary in the

kitáb-i-Aqdas. references to Tablets of the divine plan cite Tablet and paragraph numbers, e.g., "Tdp 6.8."

A

'ABDU'L-BAHÁ Servant of Bahá: the title assumed by 'Abbás effendi (23 may

1844–28 November 1921), eldest son and appointed successor of bahá'u'lláh

and the center of his covenant. upon bahá'u'lláh's ascension in 1892, 'Abdu'l-

bahá became head of the bahá'í faith in accordance with provisions revealed by

bahá'u'lláh in the kitáb-i-Aqdas and the book of the covenant. Among the titles by which he is known are the center of the covenant, the mystery of god, the master, and the perfect exemplar of bahá'u'lláh's teachings. See Tablets of the Divine Plan and Will and Testament of 'Abdu'l-Bahá.

ABHÁ Most Glorious. See Alláh-u-Abhá; Yá Bahá'u'l-Abhá. ABHÁ BEAUTY A translation of Jamál-i-Abhá, a title of Bahá'u'lláh. ABHÁ KINGDOM The Most Glorious Kingdom: the spiritual world beyond this

world. ABHÁ PARADISE See Abhá Kingdom. ADAMIC CYCLE See Cycle. ADMINISTRATIVE ORDER The international system for the administration

of the affairs of the bahá'í community. ordained by bahá'u'lláh, it is the agency through which the spirit of his revelation is to exercise its transforming effects on humanity and through which the Bahá'í World Commonwealth will be ushered in. its twin, crowning institutions are the Guardianship and the Universal House of Justice.

The institutions that make it up and the principles by which it operates are set forth in the writings of bahá'u'lláh and 'Abdu'l-Bahá. its structure was further clarified and raised up by Shoghi effendi during his ministry as guardian of the faith (1921–57). This process of elucidation continues through guidance the bahá'í faith, which is supported by National and local Spiritual Assemblies elected by members of the bahá'í community. These local and national bodies are invested with the authority to direct the bahá'í community's affairs and to uphold bahá'í laws and standards. They are also responsible for the education, guidance, and protection of the community. The Administrative order also comprises the institutions of the Hands of the Cause of God, the International Teaching Center, and the Continental Boards of Counselors and their Auxiliary Boards and assistants, who bear particular responsibility for the protection and propagation of the faith and share with the Spiritual Assemblies the functions of educating, counseling, and advising members of the bahá'í community. other institutions of the Administrative order include Puqúqu'lláh, the bahá'í Fund, the Mashriqu'l-Adhkár, and the Nineteen Day Feast. The present bahá'í Administrative order is the precursor of the World Order of Bahá'u'lláh and is described by Shoghi effendi as its "nucleus" and "pattern."

AFNÁN Twigs: the báb's kindred; specifically, descendants of his three maternal uncles and his wife's two brothers.

AGES The bahá'í dispensation is divided into three Ages: the heroic, formative, and golden Ages. The heroic Age, also called the Apostolic or primitive Age, began in 1844 with the declaration of the báb and spanned the ministries of the báb (1844–53), bahá'u'lláh (1852–92), and 'Abdu'l-b ahá (1892–1921). The transitional event most often identified with the end of the heroic Age and the beginning of the formative Age is the passing of 'Abdu'l-b ahá in 1921. The formative Age, also known as the Age of Transition or the iron Age, began in 1921 when Shoghi effendi, according to instructions in 'Abdu'l-b ahá's will and Testament, became the guardian of the cause of god and began to build bahá'u'lláh's Administrative order. The formative Age is the second and current Age; it is to be followed by the third and final Age, the golden Age destined to witness the proclamation of the most great peace and the establishment of the bahá'í world commonwealth.

“The emergence of a world community, the consciousness of world citizenship, the founding of a world civilization and culture,” Shoghi effendi wrote, “—all of which must synchronize with the initial stages in the unfoldment of the golden Age of the bahá'í era—should, by their very nature, be regarded, as far as this planetary life is concerned, as the furthestmost limits in the organization of human society, though man, as an individual, will, nay must indeed as a result of such a consummation, continue indefinitely to progress and develop.” See also Dispensation; Epochs; Bahá'í World Commonwealth.

805g l o S Sa rY

AGHṢÁN Branches: the sons and male descendants of b ahá'u'lláh.

'AKKÁ A four-thousand-year-old seaport and prison-city in northern israel surrounded by fortress-like walls facing the sea. in the mid-1800s 'Akká became a penal colony to which the worst criminals of the ottoman empire were sent. in 1868 bahá'u'lláh and his family and companions were banished to 'Akká by Sul-án 'Abdu'l-'Azíz. bahá'u'lláh was incarcerated within its barracks for two years, two months, and five days. restrictions were gradually relaxed, and he lived in a series of houses within 'Akká until june 1877, when he moved outside the city walls to the mansion of m azra'ih. b ahá'u'lláh named 'Akká “the most great prison.”

ALLÁH-U-ABHÁ God is Most Glorious: the Greatest Name, adopted as a greeting among b ahá'ís during the period of b ahá'u'lláh's exile in Adrianople (1863–68).

AMATU'L-BAHÁ RÚṢÍYYIH KHÁNUM Née mary maxwell (1910–2000), also called rúṢíyyih rabbání; daughter of may bolles maxwell and Sutherland max-

well of montreal, and wife of Shoghi effendi, the guardian of the bahá'í faith. on 26 march 1952, succeeding her illustrious father, she was appointed a hand of the cause of god residing in the holy land. Rú'íyyih (meaning "spiritual") is a name given to her by Shoghi effendi on their marriage. Khánúm is a persian title meaning "lady," "m adame," or "mrs." The title Amatu'l-Bahá (meaning "m aidservant of bahá'") was used by the guardian in a cable to a conference in chicago in 1953.

Rabbání is a surname given to Shoghi e ffendi by 'Abdu'l-b ahá.

ANCIENT BEAUTY A translation of Jamál-i-Qadím, a name of god that is also used as a title of bahá'u'lláh, who is the latest manifestation of god to human-kind. one cannot always say categorically in any passage whether the reference is to god, to b ahá'u'lláh, or to both.

ANCIENT OF DAYS See Ancient Beauty.

APOSTOLIC AGE See Ages.AQDAS Most Holy. See Kitáb-i-Aqdas, The.ARC The line of a curved path laid out by Shoghi effendi on mount carmel,

stretching across the bahá'í properties near the Shrine of the báb and centered on the monument gardens. on this Arc the seats of the "world-shaking, world-embracing, world-directing administrative institutions" of the world order of bahá'u'lláh are to be located (mA, pp. 32–33). within the Arc are the resting-places of the greatest holy leaf; her brother, the purest branch; and her mother, the most exalted leaf. edifices already constructed on the Arc include the international bahá'í Archives building (completed in 1957), the seat of the universal house of g l o S Sa rY

806justice (completed in 1982 and occupied in 1983), the international Teaching center, and the center for the Study of the Texts. The international bahá'í library has yet to be completed. See also Administrative Order; World Order of Bahá'u'lláh.

ARK The word "ark" means, literally, a boat or ship, something that affords protection and safety, or a chest or box. it is used in two senses in the bible. in the first sense it refers to the Ark of Noah, which he was bidden to build of gopher wood to preserve life during the flood. in the second sense it refers to the Ark of the covenant, the sacred chest representing to the hebrews god's presence among them. it was constructed to hold the Tablets of the law in moses' time and was later placed in the holy of holies in the Temple of jerusalem. The Ark, as a symbol of god's law and the divine covenant that is the salvation of the people in every age and

dispensation, appears in various ways in the bahá'í writings. bahá'u'lláh refers to his faithful followers as "the denizens of the crimson Ark"; he refers to the Ark of the cause and also to the Ark of his laws. A well-known passage in which this term is used appears in the Tablet of carmel: "e re long will god sail his Ark upon thee, and will manifest the people of bahá who have been mentioned in the book of Names." Shoghi effendi explains that the Ark in this passage refers to the bahá'í Administrative center on mount carmel and that the dwellers of the Ark are the members of the universal house of justice.

ARMY OF LIGHT generally, the bahá'í community, but more particularly the

"heavenly armies . . . those souls," according to 'Abdu'l-b ahá, "who are entirely freed from the human world, transformed into celestial spirits and have become divine angels. Such souls are the rays of the Sun of reality who will illumine all the continents" (Tdp 8.2).

ÁSÍYIH KHÁNUM Navváb (an honorific implying "g race" or "h ighness"); the Most Exalted Leaf: wife of bahá'u'lláh and mother of 'Abdu'l-b ahá, bahíyyih khánum, and mírzá mihdí. She was married to bahá'u'lláh in 1835, accompanied him in his exiles, and died in 1886. bahá'u'lláh named her his "perpetual consort in all the worlds of god." her resting-place is in the monument gardens on mount carmel, next to the tomb of mírzá míhdí and near that of the greatest holy leaf.

AUTHOR OF THE BAHÁ'Í REVELATION Bahá'u'lláh. AUXILIARY BOARDS An institution established by Shoghi effendi in 1954 to

act as "deputies, assistants and advisers" to the Hands of the Cause of God as they carry out their twin duties of protection and propagation. with the formation of the Continental Boards of Counselors in 1968, the hands of the cause of god were freed of responsibility for appointing, supervising, and coordinating the work of the Auxiliary boards, and these functions were transferred by the universal house of justice to the continental boards of counselors. There are two Auxiliary boards, one for protection and one for propagation; members serve on one of the

807g l o S Sa rY
rized the appointment of assistants to Auxiliary board members.

B

BÁB, THE The Gate: title assumed by Siyyid 'Alí muḩammad (20 october 1819–9 july 1850) after declaring his mission in Shíráz in 1844. The báb's station is two-fold: he is a manifestation of god and the founder of the bábí faith, and he is the

herald of bahá'u'lláh. A detailed, moving, and authoritative work titled *The Dawn-Breakers* (written by Nabíl-i-z arandí and translated by Shoghi effendi) recounts the báb's life and his followers' exploits. See balyuzi, *The Báb*.

BÁBÍYYIH, THE The Bábí place or the center of the Bábís: a house in mashhad, iran, that served as a residence for mullá ʔusayn (the first of the Letters of the Living) and quddús (also a letter of the living, whose rank was second only to that of the báb) and as a place to which inquirers came to learn about the bábí faith. The bahá'í historian Nabíl writes that "A steady stream of visitors, whom the energy and zeal of mullá ʔusayn had prepared for the acceptance of the faith, poured into the presence of quddús, acknowledged the claim of the cause, and willingly enlisted under its banner. The all-observing vigilance with which mullá ʔusayn labored to diffuse the knowledge of the new revelation, and the masterly manner in which quddús edified its ever-increasing number of adherents, gave rise to a wave of enthusiasm which swept over the entire city of mashhad, and the effects of which spread rapidly beyond the confines of khurásán. The house of bábíyyih was soon converted into a rallying center for a multitude of devotees who were fired with an inflexible resolve to demonstrate, by every means in their power, the great inherent energies of their faith." (db, p. 267)

BAHÁ'Í ELECTIONS See Elections, Bahá'í.

BAHÁ'Í FUND See Fund.
BAHÁ'Í INTERNATIONAL COMMUNITY An international body made up of

bahá'í institutions, local and national, continental and international, all closely interrelated, and comprising the worldwide membership of the bahá'í faith. Since 1948 the bahá'í international community has been affiliated with the united Nations. It assumed the function (shouldered for many years by the National Spiritual Assembly of the bahá'ís of the united States) of representing the bahá'í international community in its capacity as a nongovernmental organization at the united Nations. In 1970 the bahá'í international community was granted consultative status with the united Nations economic and Social council (ecoSoc), and in 1976 it became affiliated with the united Nations children's fund (uNicef, formerly named the united Nations children's emergency fund). It is also affiliated with the united Nations environment program (uNep). In its work with the united Nations, the bahá'í international community participates in meetings of united Nations bodies.

ies concerned with such issues as human rights, social development, the status of women, the environment, human settlement, food, science and technology, population, the law of the sea, crime prevention, substance abuse, youth, children, the family, disarmament, and the United Nations University.

BAHÁ'Í WORLD CENTER The world spiritual and administrative centers of the bahá'í faith located in the twin cities of 'Akká and Haifa in Israel. See also Arc; Administrative Order.

BAHÁ'Í WORLD COMMONWEALTH The future bahá'í community of nations, Shoghi Effendi explains, that will operate "solely in direct conformity with the laws and principles of Bahá'u'lláh" and will be animated wholly by his spirit. "Its advent will 'signalize the long-awaited advent of the Christ-promised kingdom of God on earth.' It will serve as both 'the instrument and the guardian of the most great peace.' Within the bahá'í world commonwealth 'all nations, races, creeds and classes' will be 'closely and permanently united,' and

"the autonomy of its state members and the personal freedom and initiative of the individuals that compose them" will be "definitely and completely safeguarded. This commonwealth must, as far as we can visualize it, consist of a world legislature, whose members will, as the trustees of the whole of mankind, ultimately control the entire resources of all the component nations, and will enact such laws as shall be required to regulate the life, satisfy the needs and adjust the relationships of all races and peoples. A world executive, backed by an international force,

will carry out the decisions arrived at, and apply the laws enacted by, this world legislature, and will safeguard the organic unity of the whole commonwealth. A world tribunal will adjudicate and deliver its compulsory and final verdict in all and any disputes that may arise between the various elements constituting this universal system. . . . A world metropolis will act as the nerve center . . . , the focus towards

which the unifying forces of life will converge and from which its energizing influences will radiate." The world commonwealth will include a system of international communication; an international auxiliary language; a world script and literature; a uniform and universal system of currency, weights, and measures; and an integrated economic system with coordinated markets and regulated channels of distribution. See also World Order of Bahá'u'lláh.

BAHÁ'U'LLÁH The Glory of God: title of Mírzá Ṭusayn-'Alí Núrí (12 November

1817–29 May 1892), founder of the bahá'í faith. For accounts of his life, see

Shoghi Effendi, *God Passes By*; Nabíl, *Dawn-Breakers*; and Balyuzi, *Bahá'u'lláh: The King of Glory*. Bahá'u'lláh is referred to by a variety of titles, including the promised one of All Ages, the blessed beauty, the blessed perfection, the morn of Truth, the Abhá luminary, the dayspring of the most divine essence, the Ancient beauty,

809g l o S Sa rY

the Ancient root, the Ancient of days, the Author of the bahá'í revelation, the mystic dove, the Sovereign revealer, the judge, the redeemer, the divine physician, the prince of peace, the pen of glory, the pen of the most high, the Supreme pen, the lord of hosts, and the lord of the Age. See also Book of the Covenant; Hidden Words, The; Kitáb-i-Aqdas, The.

BAHÍYYIH KHÁNUM The Greatest Holy Leaf; the Most Exalted Leaf: saintly daughter of bahá'u'lláh and outstanding heroine of the bahá'í dispensation (1846–1932). her death in 1932 marked the final end of the heroic Age of the bahá'í faith, which had drawn to a close with the passing of 'Abdu'l-b ahá in 1921. A monument erected in her memory symbolizes the bahá'í world order; its location is mount carmel, within the Arc and in close proximity to the resting-places of her brother, mírzá mihdí; her mother, ásíyih khánum; and the wife of 'Abdu'l-b ahá, munírih khánum. her station as “foremost woman of the bahá'í dispensation” and her rank among women are paralleled only by such heroines of previous dispensations as Sarah, ásíyih, the virgin mary, fá-imih, and øáhirih. for a compilation of bahá'í writings about bahíyyih khánum and for some of her own letters, see Bahíyyih Khánum: The Greatest Holy Leaf (1982).

BAHJÍ Delight, gladness, joy: the name of the property north of 'Akká where the Shrine of bahá'u'lláh is situated and where bahá'u'lláh lived from 1880 until his ascension in 1892. its extensive gardens were created by Shoghi effendi and expanded of the b ahá'í world.

BAYÁN Exposition, explanation, lucidity, eloquence, utterance: the title given by the báb to two of his major works, one in persian, the other in Arabic. it is also used sometimes to denote the entire body of h is writings.

B.E. Bahá'í Era: denotes the nineteen-month badí' calendar, which is reckoned from 21 m arch 1844, the year of the báb's declaration of h is mission.

BEST BELOVED See Ancient Beauty.BLESSED BEAUTY A translation of Jamál-i-Mubáarak, a title of bahá'u'lláh. See

also Ancient Beauty.BLESSED PERFECTION A translation of Jamál-i-Mubáarak, a title of bahá'u'lláh.

See also Ancient Beauty.BOOK OF THE COVENANT A translation of Kitáb-i-' Ahd (sometimes referred

to as Kitáb-i-' Ahdí, meaning “the book of my covenant”): bahá'u'lláh's last will and testament, designated by him as his “m ost great Tablet” and alluded to by him

as the “c rimson book.” The last Tablet revealed before his ascension, it was writ-
g l o S Sa rY

810ten in his own hand and entrusted, shortly before his passing, to his eldest son,
‘Abdu’l-b ahá. in it bahá’u’lláh clearly designates ‘Abdu’l-b ahá as his successor and
as the center of his Covenant, providing for the continuation of divine authority
over the affairs of the f aith in the future.

C

CARMEL See Mount Carmel.

CENTER FOR THE STUDY OF THE TEXTS The seat of an institution of
Sacred writings, and will prepare translations of and commentaries on the authori-
tative texts of the f aith.

CENTER OF THE COVENANT A title of ‘Abdu’l-b ahá referring to his appoint-
ment by bahá’u’lláh as the successor to whom all must turn after bahá’u’lláh’s pass-
ing. See also Covenant; Book of the Covenant.

CENTRAL FIGURES A collective reference to bahá’u’lláh, the founder of the
bahá’í faith; the báb, forerunner of bahá’u’lláh and founder of the bábí faith;
and ‘Abdu’l-b ahá, authorized i nterpreter of the b ahá’í writings.

CHIEF STEWARDS See Hands of the Cause of God.CITY OF THE COVENANT A title
designated to New york city by ‘Abdu’l-b ahá,

where he unveiled for western believers the authority given to him by bahá’u’lláh
for the definitive interpretation of h is revelation.

COMMUNITY OF THE MOST GREAT NAME The bahá’í community. See
two parts: the declaration of T rust, which sets forth the origins and duties of the
universal house of justice, and the by-laws, which specify the terms under which
tions of the b ahá’í Administrative o rder.

CONSULTATION in bahá’í usage, a technical term referring to the process of
collective decision-making. The aim of bahá’í consultation is to arrive at the best
solution or to uncover the truth of a matter. Among the requisites for consultation that are
set out in the bahá’í writings are love, harmony, purity of motive, humil-

811g l o S Sa rY

ity, lowliness, patience, and long-suffering. individuals not only have the right to
express their views, but they are expected to express them fully and with the utmost
devotion, courtesy, dignity, care, and moderation. if unanimity is not achieved, de-
cisions are arrived at by majority vote. once a decision is reached, all parties, having

had the opportunity to express their views fully, are to work together wholeheartedly to implement it. if the decision is wrong, ‘Abdu’l-b ahá says, through unity the truth will become evident and “the wrong made right.”

CONTINENTAL BOARDS OF COUNSELORS An institution of the bahá’í Ad-into the future the functions of protection and propagation of the faith assigned to the hands of the cause of god by ‘Abdu’l-b ahá in his will and Testament. and serve in five zones—Africa, the Americas, Asia, Australasia, and europe. The international Teaching center coordinates the work of the continental boards of counselors, who are assisted in their work by Auxiliary board members, whom they appoint and supervise. See also Auxiliary Boards; Hands of the Cause of God;

International Teaching Center.**CONTINENTAL FUND** See Fund.**CONTINENTAL PIONEER COMMITTEES** responsible for gathering and

supplying information for and about pioneers and international traveling teachers.

Their work complements the functions of the continental boards of counselors and National Spiritual Assemblies. There are five such committees: one each for Africa, the Americas, Asia, Australasia, and europe. members are appointed by center.

COVENANT generally, an agreement or contract between two or more people, a letter dated 23 march 1975, that a religious covenant is “a binding agreement between god and man, whereby god requires of man certain behavior in return for which he guarantees certain blessings, or whereby he gives man certain bounties in return for which he takes from those who accept them an undertaking to two types of religious covenant: “There is . . . the greater covenant which every manifestation of god makes with his followers, promising that in the fullness of time a new manifestation will be sent, and taking from them the undertaking to accept him when this occurs. There is also the lesser covenant that a manifestation of god makes with his followers that they will accept his appointed successor after him. if they do so, the faith can remain united and pure. if not, the faith becomes divided and its force spent.” in the bahá’í dispensation the greater covenant refers to the renewal of god’s ancient covenant through the appearance
g l o S Sa rY

812of the twin manifestations of god, the báb and bahá’u’lláh, and the promise of another manifestation to come in the future after the passage of at least one thousand years. The lesser covenant, in this case, refers to bahá’u’lláh’s covenant with

his followers, which establishes ‘Abdu’l-b ahá as the center of the covenant. it confers upon ‘Abdu’l-b ahá the authority to interpret bahá’u’lláh’s writings in order “to perpetuate the influence” of the faith and to “insure its integrity, safeguard it from schism, and stimulate its world-wide expansion.” The lesser covenant also sors of b ahá’u’lláh and ‘Abdu’l-b ahá.

COVENANT-BREAKER A bahá’í who attempts to disrupt the unity of the faith by defying and opposing the authority of bahá’u’lláh as the manifestation of god for this Age, or his appointed successor, ‘Abdu’l-b ahá, or after him, the guardian to violate the covenant are expelled from the faith by the universal house of justice. This provision preserves the unity of the faith, which is essential to achieving its cardinal purpose of unifying humankind. it also preserves the purity of bahá’u’lláh’s teachings from the disruptive influence of egoistic individuals who, in past dispensations, have been responsible for dividing every religion into sects, disrupting its mission, and frustrating to a large degree the intention of its founder. See also Covenant.

CRADLE OF THE FAITH iran, the homeland of the bábí and bahá’í faiths and of bahá’u’lláh, the báb, and ‘Abdu’l-b ahá.

CRUSADE, TEN YEAR WORLD The international teaching plan inaugurated by Shoghi effendi in 1953 and completed in 1963, some six years after his death. it was the first global plan in which all national bahá’í communities pursued their respective goals in one coordinated effort. it culminated with the first election of the universal h ouse of j ustice at riṣván 1963.

CYCLE A unit of time comprising the dispensations of numerous consecutive manifestations of god. for example, the Adamic, or prophetic, cycle began with Adam and ended with the dispensation of muḥammad. The bahá’í cycle began with the báb and is to last at least five hundred thousand years.

D

DANIEL’S PROPHECY The prophecy contained in daniel 12:12: “b lessed is he that waiteth, and cometh to the thousand three hundred and five and thirty days.” ‘Abdu’l-b ahá comments in a Tablet to a kurdish bahá’í, “Now concerning the verse in daniel, the interpretation whereof thou didst ask. . . . These days must be reckoned as solar and not lunar years. for according to this calculation a century will have elapsed from the dawn of the Sun of T ruth, then will the teachings of god be

firmly established upon the earth, and the divine light shall flood the world from the east even unto the west. Then, on this day, will the faithful rejoice!" 'Abdu'l-bahá further explains in the same Tablet that the 1,335 years must be reckoned from 622 a.D., the year of m uḡammad's flight from m ecra to m edina.

Shoghi effendi associates daniel's reference to the 1,335 days and 'Abdu'l-b ahá's statements about the prophecy with the centenary of bahá'u'lláh's declaration of his mission in 1863 and with the worldwide triumph of the faith. he stressed that the prophecy refers to occurrences within the bahá'í community, rather than to events in the outside world.

while Shoghi effendi clearly allied the faith's triumph with the successful completion of the third teaching plan to be undertaken by the bahá'ís, in his letters and in those written on his behalf, four specific dates are mentioned as marking the fulfillment of daniel's prophecy: 1953, 1957, 1960, and 1963. regarding the year 1960 (derived by a lunar reckoning), Shoghi effendi anticipated, in *God Passes By*, p. 151, and in a number of his letters, the successful completion of a third Seven year plan that was to be inaugurated. had there been a third Seven year plan, it would have concluded in 1960, one hundred lunar years after bahá'u'lláh's declaration. when the Ten year crusade (1953–63) was announced in 1952, Shoghi effendi linked its completion with the fulfillment of daniel's prophecy. There are also several references in letters written on Shoghi effendi's behalf that give 1957 as the date of the prophecy's fulfillment. in still other letters Shoghi effendi allies the "hundred lunar years" after bahá'u'lláh's declaration with the year 1953, although the significance of this hundred years is unclear.

Thus it seems the prophecy is not fulfilled by a single date but, rather, by a process that extended over a period of time. A letter dated 7 march 1955 written on Shoghi effendi's behalf says, "i n the Ten year crusade, we are actually fulfilling the prophecy of daniel, because with the completion of the Ten year crusade in 1963 we will have established the faith in every part of the globe." Thus the fulfillment of the prophecy coincided with the period of the Ten year crusade, a span of time that included 1953, 1957, 1960, and 1963.

DAWN-BREAKERS The bábís and early bahá'ís, many of whom gave their lives as martyrs.DAWNING PLACE OF REVELATION A title of Bahá'u'lláh, or of any Mani-

festation of God.DAY OF THE COVENANT 26 November, the day ‘Abdu’l-b ahá selected for com-

memorating the inauguration of bahá’u’lláh’s covenant. The bahá’ís wished to celebrate ‘Abdu’l-b ahá’s birthday, but he did not want this because it coincides with the anniversary of the declaration of the báb (23 may), when all attention should be given to that sacred event. he gave them instead the day of the covenant to celebrate, choosing a date that is six gregorian months away from the commemoration of b ahá’u’lláh’s Ascension. See also Covenant.

g l o S Sa rY

81DAY OF GOD An expression used variously, according to context, to refer to the appearance of a manifestation of god, to the duration of his life on earth, or to the duration of his dispensation. it is also used to refer specifically to the advent of bahá’u’lláh.

DAY OF JUDGMENT The time of the appearance of the manifestation of god, when the true character of souls is judged according to their response to his revelation. Also known as the d ay of r esurrection.

DAYSPRING OF DIVINE GUIDANCE Bahá’u’lláh.

DISPENSATION The period of time during which the laws and teachings of a prophet of god have spiritual authority. for example, the dispensation of jesus christ lasted until the beginning of the muḡammadan dispensation, usually fixed at the year 622 a.D., the year muḡammad emigrated from mecca to medina. The islamic dispensation lasted until the advent of the báb in 1844. The dispensation of the báb ended when bahá’u’lláh experienced the intimation of his mission in the Siyáh-chál, the subterranean dungeon in Tehran in which he was imprisoned between August and december 1852. The dispensation of bahá’u’lláh will last until the advent of the next manifestation of god, which bahá’u’lláh asserts will occur in no less than one thousand years.

DIVINE ESSENCE g od.

DIVINE PEN A title of Bahá’u’lláh.DIVINE PLAN The plan for the dissemination of the faith of bahá’u’lláh

throughout the world, conceived by ‘Abdu’l-b ahá and entrusted to the bahá’ís of North America in fourteen letters called the Tablets of the divine plan. The divine plan was implemented by Shoghi effendi and is pursued today under the guidance of the divine plan include the first Seven year plan (1937–44); the second Seven

year plan (1946–53) pursued at first by the bahá'ís of the united States and canada and extended by supplementary plans adopted with the approval or at the behest of Shoghi effendi by the british isles, egypt and the Sudan, germany, india, iran, and iraq; and the Ten year world crusade (1953–63), all of which were inaugurated by Shoghi effendi, and the Nine, five, Seven, Six, Three, four year, and

is divided into epochs. The first epoch included the years 1937–46; the second epoch spanned the years 1946–63; the third epoch ranged from 1963–86; and the fourth epoch was from 1986–2001. See also Crusade, Ten Year World; Epochs;

Plans; Tablets of the Divine Plan.

DIVINE THRESHOLD See Sacred Threshold.

815g l o S Sa rY

E

ELECTIONS, BAHÁ'Í elections conducted according to bahá'í principles to select individuals to serve as members of local and National Spiritual Assemblies generally held on 21 April, the first day of the riḡván festival (21 April–2 may), but in certain circumstances can be held on any day during riḡván. elections for National Spiritual Assemblies are held annually during riḡván. elections for the universal house of justice are held every five years. All adult members in good standing in a bahá'í community may vote for the members of their local Spiritual Assembly; bahá'ís in an electoral unit elect one or more delegates who, in turn, elect the members of the National Spiritual Assembly at the national convention. The members of the National Spiritual Assemblies elect the members of the universal house of justice at an international convention. Shoghi effendi advises electors

“to consider without the least trace of passion and prejudice, and irrespective of any material consideration, the names of only those who can best combine the necessary qualities of unquestioned loyalty, of selfless devotion, of a well-trained mind, of recognized ability and mature experience.” There are no nominations. campaigning and electioneering are forbidden. ballots are cast in a prayerful at-

mosphere, and the nine persons receiving the most votes are considered chosen by god. members of a minority race or group are given preference when tied for the

ninth position; otherwise, ballots are cast to break the tie. A unique and significant aspect of all bahá'í elections is the fact that voters elect with the understanding that

they are free to choose whomever their consciences prompt them to select, and they freely accept the authority of the outcome.

EPISTLE A formal or elegant letter or treatise; a composition in the form of a letter.

in bahá'í usage it refers to certain writings of bahá'u'lláh—for example, Epistle to

the Son of the Wolf.

EPOCHS major units of time used to mark the unfoldment of the Divine Plan and the formative Age. The first epoch of the formative Age (1921–46) began with the passing of ‘Abdu’l-b ahá in 1921 and ended with the conclusion of the first Seven year plan pursued by the bahá’ís of North America under Shoghi effendi’s direction. The second epoch of the formative Age (1946–63) began with the launching of the second Seven year plan and the adoption of similar plans by other national communities throughout the bahá’í world and ended with the conclusion third epoch of the formative Age (1963–86) included the Nine, five, and Seven formative Age (1986–2001), included the Six, Three, four year, and T twelve month centenary of the Ascension of b ahá’u’lláh. See also Ages.

g l o S Sa rY

816F

FAST, THE A nineteen-day period (2–21 march, the bahá’í month of ‘Alá, or loftiness) of spiritual renewal and development during which bahá’ís abstain from food and drink from sunrise to sunset. A symbol of self-restraint, the fast is a time of meditation, prayer, and spiritual recuperation and readjustment.

FEAST See Nineteen Day Feast.FIRESIDE An informal bahá’í gathering held for the purpose of discussing the

bahá’í f aith and sharing its teachings.

FOLLOWERS OF THE GREATEST NAME bahá’ís; followers of Bahá’u’lláh.

See also Greatest Name.FORMATIVE AGE See Ages.FRIENDS b ahá’ís.

FUND The institution of the bahá’í fund, of which there are four main funds, operates on the international, continental, national, and local levels.

and is used to support the work of the faith at the bahá’í world center and to sustain national communities unable to meet their own expenses. The international deputization fund, a subsidiary of the bahá’í international fund, supports the work of pioneers and traveling teachers and is administered by the international Teaching center. The persian relief fund, originally established by the National Spiritual Assembly of iran to assist victims of persecution by the islamic republic, is also a subsidiary of the bahá’í international fund and is administered by the universal h ouse of j ustice.

The continental bahá’í fund supports the work of the continental boards of

counselors and the work of their Auxiliary boards.

each National Spiritual Assembly and local Spiritual Assembly administers its own National and local fund, respectively.

The funds of the bahá'í faith are managed according to principles laid down by bahá'u'lláh, 'Abdu'l-bahá, and Shoghi effendi. foremost among the principles are: (1) except for the portion of the bahá'í funds devoted exclusively to charitable, philanthropic, or humanitarian purposes, contributions are accepted only from those who have identified themselves with the bahá'í faith and are regarded as its avowed and unreserved supporters. (2) contributing to the funds is both a spiritual privilege and a responsibility. (3) All contributions to the bahá'í funds are voluntary. (4) The degree of sacrifice and love of the contributor is more important than the amount given. (5) Appeals for donations must be dignified and general in character. (6) confidentiality of contributions is to be strictly preserved. (7)

817g l o S Sa rY

receipts are to be issued. Shoghi effendi referred to the funds as "the life-blood" of the bahá'í institutions.

G

GOD'S HOLY MOUNTAIN See Mount Carmel.

GOD'S MAJOR PLAN See Major Plan of God. GOD'S MINOR PLAN See Minor Plan of God. GOLDEN AGE See Ages. GREATEST HOLY LEAF See Bahíyyih Khánúm. GREATEST NAME The name bahá'u'lláh ("the glory of god") and its deriva-

tives, such as Alláh-u-Abhá ("god is most glorious"), Bahá ("glory," "splendor," or "light"), and yá bahá'u'l-Abhá ("o Thou the glory of the most glorious!"). Also referred to as the most great Name.

GUARDIANSHIP The institution, anticipated by bahá'u'lláh in the kitáb-i-Aqdas and established by 'Abdu'l-bahá in his will and Testament, to which Shoghi effendi was appointed. Shoghi effendi explains that the guardianship and the universal house of justice constitute the twin pillars of the world order of bahá'u'lláh and are the twin successors of bahá'u'lláh and 'Abdu'l-bahá. The guardian's chief functions are to interpret the writings of bahá'u'lláh, the báb, and 'Abdu'l-bahá and to

H

HANDS OF THE CAUSE OF GOD eminent bahá'ís appointed by bahá'u'lláh to stimulate the propagation and ensure the protection of the faith. 'Abdu'l-bahá in his will and Testament conferred authority on the guardian to appoint hands

of the cause and specified their duties. Shoghi effendi, in a message dated october 1957 to the bahá'í world, called the hands of the cause of god "the chief Stewards of bahá'u'lláh's embryonic world commonwealth." After his death on 4 November 1957 the hands of the cause of god assumed responsibility for preserving the unity of the bahá'í faith and for guiding the bahá'í world community to the victorious completion of the Ten year world crusade planned by Shoghi effendi. requested the friends not to elect them, leaving them free to discharge their own five hands of the cause of god were selected by fellow hands of the cause to serve at the bahá'í world center, while the rest continued their continental responsibilities

ties, which included overseeing the work of the Auxiliary board members. finding itself unable to appoint or legislate in order to appoint additional hands of the a letter dated 24 june 1968, announced the establishment of the institution of the continental boards of counselors to extend the functions of the hands of the cause of god into the future. The hands of the cause of god were then freed of responsibility for directing the work of Auxiliary board members and were all given worldwide responsibilities. See also Auxiliary Boards; Continental Boards of Counselors; International Teaching Center.

PA'IRATU'L-QUDS The Sacred Fold: official title designating the headquarters of bahá'í administrative activity in a particular country or region.

HEROIC AGE See Ages. **HIDDEN WORDS, THE** bahá'u'lláh's most important ethical work. revealed

circa 1858. described by Shoghi effendi as a "marvelous collection of gem-like utterances . . . with which bahá'u'lláh was inspired, as he paced, wrapped in his meditations, the banks of the Tigris." originally designated "The hidden book of fá'imih," the title of this work is an allusion to the muslim tradition that the Angel gabriel revealed a book to fá'imih to console her following the death of the prophet muḡammad, her father, and that this book remained hidden in the spiritual worlds thereafter. **HOLY DAY** A day commemorating a significant bahá'í anniversary or feast. The

nine bahá'í holy days on which work should be suspended include:

The feast of Naw-Rúz (New year), 21 march

The first day of Riḡván, 21 April

The ninth day of riḡván, 29 April The twelfth day of riḡván, 2 may

The anniversary of the declaration of the báb, 23 m ay

The anniversary of the Ascension of b ahá'u'lláh, 29 m ay

The anniversary of the martyrdom of the báb, 9 j uly

The anniversary of the birth of the báb, 20 o ctober

The anniversary of the birth of b ahá'u'lláh, 12 November

The Day of the Covenant, 26 November, and the Ascension of 'Abdu'l-b ahá, 28

November, are commemorated annually, but are not days on which work is to be suspended.

HOLY PLACES Sites in iran, iraq, T urkey, and israel that are associated with significant events in the lives of b ahá'u'lláh, the báb, and 'Abdu'l-b ahá.

819g l o S Sa rY

HOLY SHRINES See Shrine.

HOLY TEXTS See Sacred Scriptures.HOLY THRESHOLD See Sacred Threshold.HOSTS 'Abdu'l-b ahá explains that "The blessed person of the promised one

[bahá'u'lláh] is interpreted in the holy book as the lord of hosts—the heavenly armies. by heavenly armies those souls are intended who are entirely freed from the human world, transformed into celestial spirits and have become divine angels. Such souls are the rays of the Sun of reality who will illumine all the continents" (Tdp 8.2).

HOUSE OF 'ABDU'LLÁH PÁSHÁ The house in 'Akká that 'Abdu'l-b ahá rented in 1896 and that served as his residence until he moved to haifa in 1910.

HOUSES OF WORSHIP See Mashriqu'l-A dhkár.

ḤUQÚQU'LLÁH The Right of God: one of the fundamental bahá'í ordinances of the bahá'í faith, it is a great law and a sacred institution laid down by bahá'u'lláh in the kitáb-i-Aqdas. it is one of the key instruments for constructing the foundation and supporting the structure of the world order of bahá'u'lláh. its far-reaching ramifications extend from enabling individuals to express their devotion to god in a private act of conscience that attracts divine blessings and bounties for the individual, promotes the common good, and directly connects individuals with the central institution of the faith, to buttressing the authority and extending the activity of the head of the faith. The law prescribes that each bahá'í shall pay a certain portion of his accumulated savings after the deduction of all expenses and of certain exempt properties such as one's residence. These payments provide a fund at the disposition of the head of the faith for carrying

out beneficent activities. Puqúqu'lláh is administered by the universal house of justice, and payments are made to trustees appointed by the universal house of justice in every country or region. In providing a regular and systematic source of revenue for the central institution of the cause, bahá'u'lláh has assured the means for the independence and decisive functioning of the world center of his faith. The fundamentals of the law of Puqúqu'lláh are promulgated in the Kitáb-i-Aqdas. Further elaborations of its features are found in other writings of bahá'u'lláh and in those of 'Abdu'l-Bahá, Shoghi Effendi, and the universal house of justice. The law was codified in 1987 and made universally applicable as of Rixvân 1992 to all who profess belief in bahá'u'lláh. For further information, see Puqúqu'lláh: Extracts from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh, 'Abdu'l-Bahá, Shoghi Effendi.

820I

INSTITUTE See training institute.

INTERNATIONAL BAHÁ'Í ARCHIVES An institution at the bahá'í world center that preserves the writings and sacred relics of the central figures of the faith and Shoghi Effendi as well as other historical documents and items. The international Archives building, completed in 1957, was the first of five buildings on the Arc on Mount Carmel to be constructed.

INTERNATIONAL BAHÁ'Í CONVENTION An event held every five years in Haifa, Israel, at which members of National Spiritual Assemblies from around the world gather to elect the members of the universal house of justice.

INTERNATIONAL BAHÁ'Í LIBRARY The central depository of all literature published on the faith, and an essential source of information for the institutions of the world center on all subjects relating to the cause of God and the conditions of mankind.

INTERNATIONAL FUND See Fund. INTERNATIONAL TEACHING CENTER An institution established by the

universal house of justice in 1973, the members of which are the hands of the Faith at the bahá'í world center. Among the institution's many responsibilities are making and directing the work of the continental boards of counselors, being fully informed of the faith's condition throughout the world, watching over the security and ensuring the protection of the faith, and being alert to possibilities for extend-

ing the teaching work and for developing social and economic life both inside and outside the bahá'í community.

K

KING OF GLORY A title of Bahá'u'lláh.

KITÁB-I-'AHD See Book of the Covenant. **KITÁB-I-AQDAS, THE** The Most Holy Book (Kitáb means "book"; Aqdas means

"most holy"): the chief repository of bahá'u'lláh's laws and the mother book of his revelation, revealed in 'Akká in 1873 and termed by Shoghi effendi "the charter of the future world civilization." for a summary of its contents, see gpb, pp. 214–15.

KNIGHTS OF BAHÁ'U'LLÁH The title given by Shoghi effendi to bahá'ís who settled in the goal countries enumerated at the outset of the Ten year world crusade as having no bahá'ís living in them. All those who settled in such territories

821g l o S Sa rY

during the holy year october 1952–october 1953 and, thereafter, the first to settle in the remaining territories were designated knights of bahá'u'lláh. The names of the knights of bahá'u'lláh are inscribed on a scroll that was laid beneath the floor inside the entrance door of the Shrine of bahá'u'lláh in may 1992 during the holy year commemorating the centenary of bahá'u'lláh's ascension.

L

LESSER PEACE The first of two major stages in which bahá'ís believe peace will be established. The lesser peace will come about through a binding treaty among the nations for the political unification of the world. it will involve fixing every nation's boundaries, strictly limiting the size of their armaments, laying down the principles underlying the relations among governments, and ascertaining all international agreements and obligations. its inception will synchronize with two processes operating within the bahá'í faith—the maturation of local and national bahá'í institutions and the completion of specified buildings around the Arc on mount carmel—and will portend the coming of the Most Great Peace.

LETTERS OF THE LIVING A translation of *Purúf-i-Īqáyy*. The first eighteen people who independently recognized and believed in the báb. Together with him, they form the first *Váýid* ("unit") of the bábí dispensation. The word *Īqáyy*, which is the Name of god "The living," has the numerical value of eighteen in the abjad system of notation in which each letter of the Arabic alphabet is assigned a specific numerical value. The word "váýid" has the numerical value of nineteen.

LIFEBLOOD OF THE CAUSE The bahá'í Fund.

LORD OF HOSTS A title of Bahá'u'lláh. 'Abdu'l-bahá explains that "what is meant in the prophecies by the 'lord of hosts' and the 'promised christ' is the blessed perfection [bahá'u'lláh] and his holiness the exalted one [the báb]." See also Hosts.

LORD OF THE AGE A designation of the manifestation of god in each dispensation. in islam it was a title given to the promised qá'im and, therefore, is applied in bahá'í terminology particularly to the báb.

M

MAJOR PLAN OF GOD god's plan for humanity that is tumultuous and mysterious in its progress. its purpose in this cycle is to unify the human race and to establish the kingdom of god on earth. See also Minor Plan of God.

MANIFESTATION OF GOD designation of a prophet "endowed with constancy" who is the founder of a religious dispensation, inasmuch as in his words, his

person, and his actions he manifests the nature and purpose of god in accordance with the capacity and needs of the people to whom he comes.

MASHRIQU'L-ADHKÁR The Dawning-place of the Praise of God: a title designating a bahá'í house of worship or Temple. houses of worship have been constructed in Wilmette, near Chicago, Illinois; Kampala, Uganda; Ingleside, near Sydney, Australia; Langenhain, near Frankfurt am Main, Germany; Panama City, Panama; Apia, Western Samoa; and New Delhi, India. The first bahá'í house of worship, built in 1902 in 'Ishqábád, Turkmenistan, was damaged by an earthquake in 1948 and, following heavy rains, had to be razed in 1963. for a full description of the institution of the Mashriqu'l-Adhkár, see BW 18:568–88.

MASTER A title of 'Abdu'l-Bahá referring to the virtues he manifested and to his role as an enduring model for humanity to emulate.

MAZRA'IH A country mansion near the village of Mazra'a, several miles north of the prison-city of 'Akká and about a half-mile from the Mediterranean Sea. Bahá'u'lláh lived at Mazra'ih for about two years after leaving 'Akká in 1877. The mansion looks eastward to the hills of Galilee and has a pool and gardens.

MECCA The holy city of Islam, the birthplace of Muḥammad (570 A.D.). In Mecca, the principal place of pilgrimage of the Muslim world, stands the great

mosque surrounding the ka'bih (kaaba), the ancient cubical temple believed to have been built by Abraham and i shmael, which is the muslim Qiblah.

MIHDÍ, MÍRZÁ The Purest Branch: a son of bahá'u'lláh and brother of 'Abdu'l-bahá. he died at the age of twenty-two in 1870 when he fell through a skylight while rapt in prayer on the roof of the prison-barracks in 'Akká. he asked bahá'u'lláh to accept his life as a ransom so that pilgrims prevented from attaining bahá'u'lláh's presence would be enabled to do so. bahá'u'lláh, in a prayer, made this astounding proclamation: "glorified art Thou, o lord my god! Thou seest me in the hands of mine enemies, and my son blood-stained before Thy face, o Thou in whose hands is the kingdom of all names. i have, o my lord, offered up that which Thou hast given me, that Thy servants may be quickened and all that dwell on earth be united." MINOR PLAN OF GOD The part of god's plan that is revealed by bahá'u'lláh to his followers and is laid out for them in detailed instructions and successive plans the Major Plan of God, it proceeds in a methodical, ordered way, disseminating his teachings and raising up the structure of a united world society.

MOST EXALTED LEAF See Ásíyyih Khánum and Bahíyyih Khánum.

82g l o S Sa rY

MOST GREAT FESTIVAL See Riṣván.

MOST GREAT JUBILEE The centenary of the declaration of bahá'u'lláh's prophetic mission in the garden of riṣván in baghdad, 22 April–3 may 1863. it was commemorated by the first bahá'í world congress, held in royal Albert hall, london, during the riṣván festival (28 April–2 may) 1963. The most great jubilee coincided with the victorious completion of the Ten year world crusade Shoghi effendi launched in April 1953 (fulfilling the prophecy of daniel 12:12 regarding the spread of the bahá'í faith throughout the world) and the establishment of

Daniel's Prophecy. MOST GREAT NAME See Greatest Name. MOST GREAT OCEAN See Ancient Beauty. MOST GREAT PEACE The second of two major stages in which bahá'ís believe

peace will be established. The most great peace will be the practical consequence of the spiritualization of the world and the fusion of all its races, creeds, classes, and nations. it will rest on the foundation of, and be preserved by, the ordinances of god. See also Lesser Peace.

MOST GREAT PRISON The prison-city of 'Akká in which bahá'u'lláh, his family, and companions were confined from 31 August 1868 until j une 1877 .

MOST HOLY BOOK See Kitáb-i-Aqdas, The.

MOST HOLY SHRINE The Shrine of Bahá'u'lláh in Bahjí.

MOTHER TEMPLE refers to the first Bahá'í house of worship to be built in a hemisphere or continent. For example, the Bahá'í house of worship outside of Frankfurt am Main, Germany, is known as the Mother Temple of Europe; the house of worship in Wilmette, Illinois, the Mother Temple of the West.

MOUNT CARMEL A mountain in Israel on which the Shrine of the Báb and the Bahá'í World Center are located. The home of the prophet Elijah, it is referred to by Bahá'u'lláh as "the hill of God and his vineyard" and was extolled by Isaiah as the "mountain of the Lord" to which "all nations shall flow." On it Bahá'u'lláh pitched his tent and revealed the Tablet of Carmel, the charter of the world spiritual and administrative centers of the Bahá'í Faith. See also Arc; Bahá'í World Center.

MYSTERY OF GOD A translation of Sirr-u'lláh, a title Bahá'u'lláh gave to 'Abdu'l-Bahá referring to his unique spiritual station in which the incompatible characteristics of human nature and superhuman knowledge and perfection are blended and completely harmonized.

N

NATIONAL CONVENTION The institution that elects the members of the National Spiritual Assembly during the annual Riḍván festival (April 21–May 2). At unit or "district" conventions, adult Bahá'ís elect delegates who, in turn, attend the National convention. There the delegates vote to elect the members of the National Spiritual Assembly, consult about the affairs of the Faith, and offer recommendations to the National Spiritual Assembly. See also Elections, Bahá'í.

NATIONAL SPIRITUAL ASSEMBLIES See Spiritual Assemblies. NAW-RÚZ New Day: Bahá'í New Year's day, the date of the vernal equinox. A

Bahá'í holy day on which work is suspended, it is celebrated in the West on 21

date throughout the world in accordance with astronomical data. NIGHTINGALE OF PARADISE See Ancient Beauty. NINE YEAR PLAN The first teaching plan launched by the universal house of

justice. It encompassed the years 1964–73. See also Plans.

NINETEEN DAY FEAST A Bahá'í institution inaugurated by the Báb and confirmed by Bahá'u'lláh in the Kitáb-i-Aqdas. It is held on the first day of every Bahá'í month, each consisting of nineteen days and bearing the name of one of the at-

tributes of god. The feast is the heart of bahá'í community life at the local level and consists of devotional, consultative, and social elements.

O

ORDER OF BAHÁ'U'LLÁH See World Order of Bahá'u'lláh.

P

PEERLESS BELOVED See Ancient Beauty.

PEN OF GLORY, PEN OF THE MOST HIGH See Ancient Beauty. PEOPLE OF BAHÁ' generally, the members of the bahá'í community. Shoghi

effendi explains that in the Tablet of carmel "the people of bahá" refers to the members of the universal house of justice.

825g l o S Sa rY

PILGRIM HOUSE A house for visiting pilgrims that mírzá ja'far ra'ymání built, with 'Abdu'l-bahá's permission, near the Shrine of the báb. 'Abdu'l-bahá composed a dedicatory inscription that appears above its entrance: "This is a spiritual hostel for pilgrims, and its founder is mírzá ja'far ra'ymání 1327 a.H. [1909]." it was completed in 1909 and was known as the eastern or oriental pilgrim house. in that pilgrims should be accommodated in hotels, thereby enabling it to convert the pilgrim house into a reception center.

A western pilgrim house was built across the street from the house of 'Abdu'l-bahá in haifa, shortly after his passing, with funds American bahá'ís had contributed and in accordance with a design 'Abdu'l-bahá had selected and modified. in the western pilgrim house became the seat of the international Teaching center.

Another pilgrim house is located at bahjí, near the Shrine of bahá'u'lláh.

PILGRIMAGE A journey made with the intention of visiting a shrine or holy place. for bahá'ís it is both a privilege and an obligation, although it is only obliga-

tory for men who are able to make the journey. in the kitáb-i-Aqdas bahá'u'lláh specifically ordains pilgrimage to the house of bahá'u'lláh in baghdad and to the house of the báb in Shíráz. on the day of bahá'u'lláh's Ascension, the room where his holy dust was laid became a third center of pilgrimage—the most holy spot and the Qiblih of the bahá'í world—for at least the next thousand years. under current conditions, bahá'ís assume that the obligation of pilgrimage is satisfied by a visit to the Shrine of bahá'u'lláh and the Shrine of the báb in the holy land.

The first group of western pilgrims arrived in 'Akká on 10 december 1898 and included edward and lua getsinger; phoebe hearst; mrs. hearst's butler, robert

Turner, who was the first African-American in the west to become a bahá'í; and Mrs. Thornburgh.

semblies. See also Spiritual Assemblies.

PIONEERS bahá'ís who leave their hometown or country to reside elsewhere for the purpose of teaching the bahá'í faith.

PLANS refers to the courses of action devised by Shoghi Effendi and, later, by the Universal House of Justice for expanding and consolidating the bahá'í faith within the framework of 'Abdu'l-Bahá's Divine Plan. Teaching plans launched by Shoghi Effendi include the first Seven year plan (1937–44) and the second Seven year plan (1946–53) pursued by the bahá'ís of the United States; a Six year plan pursued by the bahá'ís of the British Isles (1944–50); plans of varying durations separately pursued between 1947–53 by the National Spiritual Assemblies of Canada, of Central and South America, of South America, of Australia and New Zealand, of India, Pakistan, and Burma, of Germany and Austria, of Iran, of Iraq, and of Egypt and the Sudan; the Two year plan for the development of the faith in Africa; and the Ten year world crusade (1953–63) pursued by the worldwide bahá'í community. The Universal House of Justice has launched the Nine year plan (1964–73), the five year plan (1974–79), the Seven year plan (1979–86), the Six year plan (1986–92), the Three year plan (1993–1996), the four year plan (1996–2000), the Twelve month plan (2000–2001), and two five year plans (2001–2006 and 2006–2011). See also Major Plan of God and Minor Plan of God.

PROMISED ONE Bahá'u'lláh. PUREST BRANCH, THE See Mihdí, Mírzá.

Q

QIBLIH “That which one faces; prayer-direction; point of adoration”: the focus to which the faithful turn in prayer. The qiblah for Muslims is the Ka'bah in Mecca; for bahá'ís it is the most holy Tomb of Bahá'u'lláh at Bahjí, “the heart and qiblah of the bahá'í world.”

R

this new element of the bahá'í Administrative Order, serves as a link between the local and national levels. These institutions are formed only in certain countries where the growing complexity of the issues which are facing National Spiritual Assemblies requires this development. A regional council is established either

through election by the members of the Local Spiritual Assemblies in a region or through appointment by the National Spiritual Assembly.

REMOTE PRISON The city of Adrianople (now Edirne, Turkey), to which Bahá'u'lláh was banished from 12 December 1863 through 12 August 1868. Adrianople is in western Turkey, on its border with Greece and Bulgaria.

REVELATION The conveying of truth from God to humanity. The word is used to refer to the process of divine communication from God to his manifestation and from the manifestation to his people; to the words and acts of such communication themselves; and to the entire body of teachings given by a prophet of God.

RIḌVÁN The Islamic name of the gardener and custodian of paradise. In Bahá'í terminology the word denotes both "garden" and "paradise"; however, it has also been used to denote God's good-pleasure and his divine acceptance. The Riḍván festival, the holiest and most significant of all Bahá'í festivals, commemorates 827 G L O S S A R Y

Bahá'u'lláh's declaration of his mission to his companions in the garden of Riḍván in Baghdad in 1863. It is a twelve-day period celebrated annually, 21 April–2 May. It is also called the Most Great Festival. During each Riḍván festival local and National Spiritual Assemblies are elected, and, once every five years, the Universal House of Justice is elected.

RUHI INSTITUTE A system whose materials seek to integrate focused study of the Bahá'í writings with specific acts of service for the community. Organized as a series of levels of study, which aim to develop an understanding of the essential spiritual verities taught by Bahá'u'lláh, the courses are self-perpetuating in nature, developing human resources who in turn are able to arise to serve the community and teach the courses to others.

RÚḤÍYYIH KHÁNUM, AMATU'L-BAHÁ See Amatu'l-Bahá Rúḥíyyih Khánum.

S

SACRED SCRIPTURES, SACRED TEXTS The holy books of the world's religions. Also refers to the writings of Bahá'u'lláh, the Báb, and 'Abdu'l-Bahá.

SACRED THRESHOLD A term used metaphorically and respectfully to denote approach to the presence of God and, hence, to the precincts of a holy place such as a shrine. It is also sometimes used literally to denote the actual outer or inner

threshold of a holy shrine.

SEAL OF THE PROPHETS m uṣammad.

SHOGHI EFFENDI The title by which Shoghi rabbání (1 march 1897–4 November 1957), great-grandson of bahá'u'lláh, is generally known to bahá'ís. (Shoghi is an Arabic name meaning “the one who longs”; Effendi is a Turkish honorific signifying “sir” or “master.”) he was appointed guardian of the bahá'í faith by ‘Abdu'l-bahá in his will and assumed the office upon ‘Abdu'l-bahá's passing in

1921. SHRINE The original meaning of the word is a casket or case for books, but it later acquired the special meaning of a casket containing sacred relics, and thence a tomb of a saint, a chapel with special associations, or a place hallowed by some memory. it is used to denote the latter in bahá'í terminology. The term “holy Shrines,” for example, refers to the burial places of bahá'u'lláh, the báb, and ‘Abdu'l-bahá. The house associated with the visit of ‘Abdu'l-bahá to montreal was designated by Shoghi effendi as a bahá'í shrine. Also, when referring to the All-American convention held in 1944 to commemorate the one hundredth anniversary of the inception of the bahá'í faith, the guardian wrote of the representatives of the American

g l o S Sa rY

828bahá'í community's being “gathered within the walls of its national Shrine—the most sacred Temple ever to be reared to the glory of bahá'u'lláh” (gpb p. 400).

SÍYÁH-CHÁL Black Pit: the subterranean dungeon in Tehran in which bahá'u'lláh was imprisoned August–December 1852. here, chained in darkness three flights of stairs underground, in the company of his fellow-bábís and some 150 thieves and assassins, he received the first intimations of his world mission.

SPIRITUAL ASSEMBLIES Administrative institutions of bahá'u'lláh's world order that operate at the local and national levels and are elected according to bahá'í principles. They are responsible for coordinating and directing the affairs of the bahá'í community in their areas of jurisdiction. The institution of the local Spiritual Assembly is ordained by bahá'u'lláh in the kitáb-i-Aqdas (referred to there as the “house of justice”); the institution of the National Spiritual Assembly is established by ‘Abdu'l-bahá in his will and Testament. The term “Spiritual Assembly” was introduced by ‘Abdu'l-bahá so that, while the faith is still generally unknown, people will not make the false deduction from the term “house of justice” that it is a political institution. regional Spiritual Assemblies have been elected in many areas and are gradually reduced in size and eventually replaced by National Spiritual Assemblies as the faith expands and consolidates itself. See also Elections, Bahá'í.

SUPREME HOUSE OF JUSTICE See Universal House of Justice.

SUPREME PEN A title of Bahá'u'lláh. SÚRIY-I-MULÚK Tablet to the Kings: revealed by Bahá'u'lláh in Adrianople, re-

ferred to by Shoghi effendi as "the most momentous Tablet revealed by Bahá'u'lláh."

in it Bahá'u'lláh addresses collectively the monarchs of east and west, the Sultans of Turkey, the kings of Christendom, the French and Persian ambassadors to the Ottoman Empire, the Muslim clergy in Constantinople, the people of Persia, and the philosophers of the world. In the Súriy-i-Mulúk Bahá'u'lláh unequivocally and forcefully proclaims his station. See Proclamation of Bahá'u'lláh (pp. 7-12, 47-54, 102-03) for passages of the Súriy-i-Mulúk that have been translated into English.

T

TABLET OF CARMEL The charter of the world spiritual and administrative centers of the Bahá'í Faith, revealed by Bahá'u'lláh in 1890 during one of his visits to Mount Carmel. See GWB, no. 11, or TB, pp. 3-5.

TABLETS refers to letters revealed by Bahá'u'lláh, the Báb, and 'Abdu'l-Bahá.

TABLETS OF THE DIVINE PLAN fourteen Tablets revealed by 'Abdu'l-Bahá in 1916 and 1917 and referred to as the charter for propagating the Bahá'í Faith.

TABLETS OF THE DIVINE PLAN

Addressed to the Bahá'ís of North America, the Tablets convey his mandate for the transmission of the Bahá'í Faith throughout the world. See also Divine Plan.

TEN YEAR WORLD CRUSADE See Crusade, Ten Year World.

TONGUE OF GRANDEUR See Ancient Beauty. TRAINING INSTITUTE. A program designed to enrich the spiritual life of the

participants and enable them to perform specific acts of service such as engaging in teaching activities, giving deepening courses, teaching children's classes, and activating Bahá'í community life.

TRANSITION, AGE OF or PERIOD OF See Ages.

TWIN HOLY CITIES Haifa and 'Akká, Israel.

TWIN HOLY SHRINES The Shrines of Bahá'u'lláh and the Báb. See also Shrines.

U

UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE The supreme governing and legislative body of the Bahá'í Administrative Order. Elected every five years, it provides spiritual guidance to and directs the administrative activities of the worldwide Bahá'í community. It is the institution Bahá'u'lláh ordained as the agency invested with authority to legislate on matters not covered in his writings. In his will and

Testament ‘Abdu’l-b ahá elaborates on its functions and affirms that it is infallibly guided.

W

WILL AND TESTAMENT OF ‘ABDU’L-BAHÁ A document that Shoghi effendi says is “unique in the annals of the world’s religious systems,” the will and

Testament is the charter of the Administrative order of the bahá’í faith. written, signed, and sealed by ‘Abdu’l-b ahá, the will and Testament consists of three sections written at three different times between 1901 and the year of his passing. The will and Testament affirms “the two-fold character of the mission of the báb,” which was to bring an independent revelation from god and to herald the coming of another, greater revelation through bahá’u’lláh. it also “discloses the full station of” bahá’u’lláh as the “Supreme manifestation of god,” declares the fundamental beliefs of the bahá’í faith, establishes the institution of the guardianship, and appoints Shoghi effendi as guardian. it provides for the election of the universal house of justice and defines its scope. it also creates the institution of the National g l o S Sa rY

80Spiritual Assembly, provides for the appointment of the hands of the cause of god and prescribes their obligations, and exposes the conduct of the covenant-breakers.

WORLD CENTER See Bahá’í World Center.

WORLD CONGRESS See Most Great Jubilee.

WORLD CRUSADE See Crusade, Ten Year World.WORLD ORDER OF BAHÁ’U’LLÁH bahá’u’lláh’s “scheme for world-wide soli-

darity” that is “destined to embrace in the fullness of time the whole of mankind.”

The current bahá’í Administrative order is its nucleus and pattern, providing the

“rudiments of the future all-enfolding b ahá’í commonwealth.”

Y

YÁ ‘ALÍYYU’L-A’LÁ O Thou the Exalted, the Most Exalted! A form of the Báb’s name that is used as an invocation.

YÁ BAHÁ’U’L-ABHÁ O Thou the Glory of the Most Glorious! A form of Bahá’u’lláh’s name (the Greatest Name) that is used as an invocation.

81Selected p ublications

Writings of Bahá’u’lláh

Epistle to the Son of the Wolf. 1st pocket-size ed. T ranslated by Shoghi effendi. wil-

mette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1988.

Gems of Divine Mysteries: Javáhiru'l-Asrár. h aifa: bahá'í world centre, 2002.

Gleanings from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh. Translated by Shoghi Effendi. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing, 2005.

The Hidden Words. Translated by Shoghi Effendi. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing, 2002.

The Kitáb-i-Aqdas: The Most Holy Book. 1st pocket-size ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1993.

The Kitáb-i-Íqán: The Book of Certitude. Translated by Shoghi Effendi. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing, 2003.

Prayers and Meditations. Translated by Shoghi Effendi. 1st pocket-size ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1987 .

Summons of the Lord of Hosts: Tablets of Bahá'u'lláh. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing, 2006.

The Tabernacle of Unity: Bahá'u'lláh's Responses to Mánikchí Bá'ib and Other Writings. h aifa: bahá'í world centre, 2006.

Tablets of Bahá'u'lláh revealed after the Kitáb-i-Aqdas. compiled by the research herzadeh et al. wilmette, il: 1988.

Writings of the Báb

Selections from the Writings of the Báb. compiled by the research department of pocket-sized ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 2006.

Writings of 'Abdu'l-Bahá

'Abdu'l-Bahá in Canada. Thornhill, Ontario: bahá'í canada publications, 1987 .

'Abdu'l-Bahá in London: Addresses and Notes of Conversations. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1982.

Memorials of the Faithful. New ed. Translated by marzieh gail. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1996.

Selected Publications

82Paris Talks: Addresses Given by 'Abdu'l-Bahá in Paris in 1911. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing, 2006.

Promulgation of Universal Peace: Talks Delivered by 'Abdu'l-Bahá during His Visit to the United States and Canada in 1912. compiled by howard macNutt. 2nd ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 2007 .

The Secret of Divine Civilization. Translated by Marzieh Gail with Ali-kuli Khan. 1st pocket-sized ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing, 2007.

Selections from the Writings of 'Abdu'l-Bahá. compiled by the research department world center and Marzieh Gail. 1st pocket-size ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1996.

Some Answered Questions. compiled and translated by Laura Clifford Barney. 1st pocket-size ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1984.

Tablets of the Divine Plan. 1st pocket-sized ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1993.

A Traveler's Narrative Written to Illustrate the Episode of the Báb. Translated by Edward G. Browne. New and corrected ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1980.

Will and Testament of 'Abdu'l-Bahá. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1944.

Writings of Shoghi Effendi

Advent of Divine Justice. 1st pocket-size ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1990.

Arohanui: Letters from Shoghi Effendi to New Zealand. Suva, Fiji: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1982.

Bahá'í Administration: Selected Messages 1922–1932. 7th ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1974.

Citadel of Faith: Messages to America, 1947–1957. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1965.

Directives from the Guardian. compiled by Gertrude Garrida. New Delhi: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1973.

God Passes By. New ed. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1974.

High Endeavours: Messages to Alaska. Wilmette, IL: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1976.

Japan Will Turn Ablaze: Tablets of 'Abdu'l-Bahá, Letters of Shoghi Effendi and the Universal House of Justice, and Historical Notes about Japan. compiled by Barbara R. Sims. revised ed. Tokyo: Bahá'í Publishing Trust, 1992.

Letters of the Guardian to Australia and New Zealand, 1923–1957. Sydney, NSW: National Spiritual Assembly of the Bahá'ís of Australia and New Zealand, 1970.

The Light of Divine Guidance: The Messages of the Guardian of the Bahá'í Faith to

the Bahá'ís of Germany and Austria. 2 vols. hofheim-langenhain: bahá'í-verlag, 1982, 1985.

Messages to America. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing committee: 1947 .

Selected Publications

Messages to the Bahá'í World: 1950–1957. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1971.

Messages to Canada. Toronto: bahá'í canada publications, 1965.

Messages of Shoghi Effendi to the Indian Subcontinent, 1923–1957.

The Promised Day Is Come. 1st pocket-size ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1996.

This Decisive Hour: Messages of Shoghi Effendi to the North American Bahá'ís, 1932–1946. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 2002.

The Unfolding Destiny of the British Bahá'í Community: The Messages from the Guardian of the Bahá'í Faith to the Bahá'ís of the British Isles. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1981.

The World Order of Bahá'u'lláh: Selected Letters. 1st pocket-size ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1991.

The Institution of the Counsellors. A document prepared by the universal house of justice. haifa: bahá'í world centre, 2001.

Formative Age. compiled by geoffrey w. marks. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1996.

The Promise of World Peace: To the Peoples of the World. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1985.

Compilations of Bahá'í Writings

bahá'u'lláh, the báb, and 'Abdu'l-bahá. Bahá'í Prayers: A Selection of Prayers Revealed by Bahá'u'lláh, the Báb, and 'Abdu'l-Bahá. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 2002.

bahá'u'lláh, the báb, 'Abdu'l-bahá, and Shoghi effendi. The Power of Divine Assistance. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. oxford, england: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1981.

———. Trustworthiness. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1987 .

bahá'u'lláh, the báb, 'Abdu'l-bahá, Shoghi effendi, and the universal house of justice. Compilation of Compilations. 3 vols. Australia: bahá'í publications

Australia, 1991, 2000.

———. The Covenant. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1988.

———. Teaching with the Media: A Compilation on Media, Knowledge, Audience, Persuasion, and Unity. compiled by the National Teaching committee of the united States. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1999.

bahá'u'lláh and 'Abdu'l-bahá. Bahá'í World Faith: Selected Writings of Bahá'u'lláh and 'Abdu'l-Bahá. 2nd ed. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1976.

Selected Publications

8———. The Importance of Obligatory Prayer and Fasting: A Selection of Extracts and Prayers from the Bahá'í Writings. compiled by the research department of Australia, 2001.

bahá'u'lláh, 'Abdu'l-bahá, and Shoghi effendi. Excellence in All Things: A compilation of Extracts from the Bahá'í Writings. compiled by the research department publications Australia, 1982.

———. Family Life. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. wilmette, il: bahá'í publishing Trust, 2008.

Chaste and Holy Life. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1988.

———. Conservation of the Earth's Resources. prepared by the research department

———. Consultation: A Compilation. compiled by the research department of 1995.

———. Crisis and Victory. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1988.

———. Puqúqu'lláh: The Right of God. compiled by the research department 2007 .

———. The Importance of the Arts in Promoting the Faith. ontario: bahá'í publications canada, 1999.

———. Scholarship. prepared by the research department of the universal house of justice. montréal, Australia: bahá'í publications Australia, 1995.

———. Teaching Prominent People. based on material issued by the research department Trust, 1990.

———. Unlocking "The Power of Action. " A compilation prepared by the research

committee for the Southern States, 1997 .

———. Women: Extracts from the Writings of Bahá'u'lláh, ' Abdu'l-Bahá, Shoghi Effendi Publications, 1986.

statement and compilation prepared by the research department of the universal house of justice. mona vale, Australia: bahá'í publications Australia, 1994.

———. Bahá'í Elections. compiled by the research department of the universal house of justice. london: bahá'í publishing Trust, 1990.

85index of Names

'Abdu'l-bahá. See general index

Abu'l-ḥasan, j ináb-i-hájí Amín

(Trusted one), 21.20–22

Afaqi, Sabir, 97 .2c, 207 .2

Afshin, borhanoddin, 97 .2c, 207 .1c,

344.2a

Afshín, i raj, execution of, 59.4–5

Ahderom, Techeste, 342.9Ahdieh, h ushang, 97 .2a, 200.10,

207 .2; passing of, 241.1

Ahmadiyah, h edayatollah, passing

of, 93

Akhtarí, Ardishír, execution of, 37 .1–2Akhtar khávarí, khudáyár, 139.5

'Akhúnd, j ináb-i-hájí (h and of the

cause of god), 21.19, 21.21

Ala'i, Suhayl, 97 .4Allen, b eth, 344.1a

Allen, g eorge, 54.3, 97 .2a, 129.18,

207 .1a, 344.1a

Amánat, ḥusayn, 23.8jAndrews, e ugene, 344.1b

Anello, e loy, 97 .2b, 207 .1b, 344.1b

Annan, k ofi, 331.19

Anvari, h oushmand, 179.2, 179.4,

179.8a

A'rábí, p anj'alí, 139.5

Arbab, f arzam, 51.1, 54.1, 129.18,

152.1, 264.1

Arbab, laurie, passing of, 322Ardakání, hájī Abu'l-ḥasan, 21.20Ardekani, f adel, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 344.1c

Ardekani, h usayn, 97 .4

Armstrong, leonora h olsapple, 233.2Asare, b eatrice o., 97 .2a, 207 .1a,

344.1a

ásíyih khánum (Navváb, m ost
exalted leaf). See g eneral i ndex

Ayala, b en, 54.4, 97 .2d, 207 .1d,

344.2a

Ayman, i raj, 54.2

báb, The. See g eneral i ndex

bádkúbí'í, mrs., 139.7abahá'u'lláh. See g eneral i ndex

bahíyyih khánum (greatest h oly
leaf). See g eneral i ndex

bahjestani, m ahmud kiani, 288.1,
288.2

bahta, g ila m ichael, 97 .2a, 207 .2

bakhshandegi, Amin, 179.5

bakhshandegi, b adri, 179.5

bakhshandegi, Shamam, 179.2, 179.4,
179.5

baki, f evziye, 344.1e

balazadeh, h ooshidar, 207 .1e, 344.2a

ballerio, g iovanni, 279.3–6, 299.9

barnes, kiser, 97 .2a, 154.1, 267 .1,
327 .1

barrett, d onald, 23.4

baskaran, Nidavanur, 274.1, 344.1c

bates, r onald, 23.4

bekkum, o nno f rank van, 75.1

benson, b eatrice, 97 .2d, 207 .1d,
344.1d

benson, richard, 97 .4
 bergsmo, m orten, 75.1
 bihmardí, f aríd, execution of, 3
 i nDe x o f n a m e S
 86birkland, Stephen, 156.1, 207 .1b,
 344.1b
 blanks, d onald, 293.1, 344.1d
 bopp, Anneliese, 51.1
 borets, Alla, 344.1eboth, u ta von, 207 .1e, 344.1e
 buddha. See g eneral i ndex
 bushrui, Niaz, 207 .1a, 344.1a
 calderón, i sabel de, 97 .4
 cardoso, f ernando h enrique, 233.4
 carney, magdalene, 5 1.1; passing of, 117
 chan, lady, 158.1chan, Sir j ulius, 158.1
 chance, h ugh e., 49, 142.1–2;
 passing of, 260
 chance, m argaret, 260.1
 chang, Afemata m oli, 97 .2d, 207 .1d,
 290.1
 chittleborough, d avid, 207 .1d,
 344.1d
 christ. See g eneral i ndex
 chung, i rene, 344.1c
 clinton, b ill, 188.2
 cole, j uan ricardo, 12.2, 12.7–8
 coles, p atricia, 207 .1e, 344.2a
 copithorne, m aurice, 321.3
 correa, g ustavo, 54.3, 97 .2b, 207 .1b,
 344.1b
 czékus, r olf von, 97 .2b, 129.18,
 207 .1b, 267 .1
 dahmúbidí, dáryúsh, 139.4

dánishníyá, Adíb, 139.5davis, lady, 4.1–2
 davis, Sir Thomas, 4.1-2, 279.2
 delahunt, j acqueline left-h and b ull,
 54.3, 97 .2b, 207 .1b, 344.2a
 dhabihi m uqaddam, Sirus, 278.4,
 280.7, 341.2
 djoneydi, p arvine, 97 .2a, 129.18,
 207 .1a, 344.2a
 dooki, i rma Nelly de, 344.1b
 dunbar, h ooper, 49.1, 152.1, 264.1effendi, j amal, 332.2
 ehsani, m ehraz, 97 .2a, 207 .1a, 344.1a
 eidelkhani, j abbar, 207 .1c, 344.1c
 ekpe, f riday, 97 .2a, 207 .2
 ellis, w ilma m., 97 .2b, 207 .1b,
 344.2a
 enayati, m asha'llah, martyrdom of,
 254.2, 254.4a–4c
 epyeru, o loro, 97 .4
 esau (old Testament figure), 229.18
 eshraghian, kamran, 97 .2d, 207 .2ewing, Tod, 207 .1b, 344.2a
 faná'íyán, changíz, 39.2
 fanaiyan, d erakhshan, 289.5
 fanaiyan, m inu z amani, 289.5
 farid, b ijan, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 344.1c
 fat'he-Aazam, Shidan, 97 .2a, 207 .1a,
 344.2a
 fatheazam, h ushmand, 49.1, 152.1,
 264.1
 featherstone, collis (h and of the
 cause of g od), 90.3; passing of,
 95
 feizouré, clément-Thyrrel, 344.1a
 ferdosian, h abibullah, 289.1

ferraby, d orothy, passing of, 178

filho, Antonio g abriel m arque, 274.1, 344.1a

fofana, kassimi, 97 .2a, 207 .2

fozdar, j ohn, 97 .2c, 207 .2

furútan, ‘Alí-Akbar (h and of the cause of g od): bwc activities, 91.1, 186.3, 216.15; at counselors’ meetings, 53.2, 157 .1, 212.2, 275.2, 331.29, 350.2; at NSA inaugural conventions, 90.3, 108.6, 129.18

fynn, k obina, 156.1, 207 .1a, 344.1a

gabriel (angel). See g eneral i ndex

galadima, i brahim, 207 .1a, 344.1a

galindo p ohl, r eynaldo, 135.3, 136.3c, 137 .2g, 268.5

87i nDe x o f n a m e S

gandhi, m ahatma, 202.7

gershuny, linda, 207 .1b, 344.2a

ghadirian, Abdu’l-m issagh, 207 .1b, 344.1b

ghaznavi, Agnès, 97 .4

ghedami, rúŷu’lláh, murder of, 134.1–3

god. See g eneral i ndex

grossmann, h artmut, 51.1, 54.1, 129.18, 154.1, 267 .1

grouzkova, e lena, 207 .1c, 344.1c

gulmuŷammadí, z abíhu’llah, 97 .4

haake, v iolette, 54.3, 97 .2d, 207 .1d, 267 .1

þájíþúr, j amáli’d-dín, 268.1, 268.4, 268.5, 280.4

þájíyán, Suhráb, 39.2

pakhámanishí, írándukht, 139.5hakiman, Sina, 289.1, 297 .1, 297 .4

hancock, Tinai, 97 .2d, 207 .2
 harris, r obert, 97 .4
 hénuzet, louis, 97 .2e, 207 .1e, 344.2ahermes (prophet), 7 .5
 pishmarí, q udratu'lláh, 139.6b
 hissani, h izzaya, 54.3, 97 .2a, 207 .1a,
 344.2a
 hofman, d avid, 43.1
 hofmann, Nadi, 75.1
 huang, d avid, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 344.1c
 huerta, Angélica, 344.1b
 imam þusayn, 140.5c
 isaac (old Testament figure), 229.18
 isaiah (prophet), 176.11
 ishráqí, Aẓmad, 139.7b
 iwakura, Nobuko, 156.1, 207 .1c,
 344.2a
 jabbárí, Surúsh, execution of, 19.1–2,
 37 .2
 jacob (old Testament figure),
 229.18
 javaheri, f iraydoun, 207 .1a, 267 .1john p aul ii, pope, 108.9, 314.1,
 331.20
 jumalon, h umaida, 344.1c
 kabua, Amata, 279.2kámrán mírzá (son of Ná'irí'd-dín
 Shah), 21.21
 kashmírí, mr., 139.3
 katirai, Abbas, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 344.2akavelin, borrah, 43.1kávih, Aẓmad, execution of,
 16.1kazemi, z ekrullah, 97 .2a, 207 .1a,
 344.2a
 kazemzadeh, f oad, 97 .2e, 207 .2
 kebdani, m uẓammad, 97 .2a
 khadem, z ikrullah (h and of the
 cause of g od), passing of, 11.1

khadem-m issagh, b ijan, 299.10
 khalajabadi, kayvan, 135.2–3, 136.1–
 2, 136.3d–3f, 137 .1–2k, 239.5, 289.6
 khamenei, Ayatollah Ali h oseyni,
 268.5, 287 .5, 288.6
 khamsí, m as'úd, 51.1, 129.18, 154.1
 khan, p eter, 20.1, 49.1, 152.1, 264.1
 khánjání, j amálu'd-d in, 39.1
 khazeh, j alal (h and of the cause of
 god), passing of, 87 .1
 khelghati, Thelma, 54.2khulusi, m anuchehr, 321.4, 334.1–3
 king, lauretta, 51.1, 54.1, 154.1,
 181.11, 267 .1
 koirala, b harat, 97 .4
 lanfranchi, Alessandra, 75.1lincoln, Albert, 340.1, 342.6lincoln, j oan, 154.1, 267 .1
 locke, h ugh, 188.3
 ludher, lee lee, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 344.1c
 lur, 'Atá'u'lláh, 139.5
 lur, jamshíd, 139.5
 lutchmaya, e ddy, 180.2, 207 .1a,
 344.1a
 lutchmaya, r oddy, passing of, 74, 77
 i nDe x o f n a m e S
 88mabuku, w ingi, 97 .2a, 207 .1a, 344.2a
 ma'ǝbúbí, ǝasan, 39.1
 mahrami, z abihullah, 239.1–4, 289.6
 majmeto, b etra, 97 .2d, 207 .1d, 344.2a
 major, j ohn, 188.2
 maka, lisiata, 97 .4
 makhele, e nos, 344.1a
 martin, d ouglas, 152.1, 264.1
 masrour, h ervé, 344.1b
 mawhibatí, mrs., 139.6c

maxwell, m ay, fiftieth anniversary of
 passing, 86

mayberry, f lorence, passing of, 262

maḥlú mí, mr., 59.7

mazlumi-Nosratabad, h ossain, 289.5

mcgill, john, 75.1

mclaren, p eter, 54.4, 97 .2b, 207 .1b,
 344.2a

mehrabi, m ansur, 268.1, 268.4,
 268.5, 280.4, 284.1

merhatsion, Abaineḥ, 207 .1a; passing
 of, 320

mihdí-Nizhád, íraj, 9.2–3

miller, Alejandra, 207 .1b, 344.2a

mills, j alal, 344.1d

mírzá m ihdi (The p urest b ranch). See
 general i ndex

mírzá m uḡammad-‘Alí. See g eneral
 index

mírzá y aḡyá. See g eneral i ndex

mirzapanah, z iaullah, 289.1, 297 .1,
 297 .4

mitchell, g lenford, 49.1, 152.1, 264.1

mithaqi, b ehnam, 135.2–3, 136.1–3c,
 137 .1–2k, 239.5, 289.6

mítháqí, m aryam, 136.3b

mkandawire, m aina, 344.1a

mogharrabi, Abdullah, martyrdom
 of, 311

moghbel, f irouzeh, 344.1e

mohajer, p ayman, 115.1, 207 .1c, 267 .1

montazi, r ouhollah, 97 .4

monadjem, Shapoor, 97 .2b, 154.1,

181.11, 267 .1monajjem, catherine, 344.1b

morrison, g ayle, 97 .2d, 207 .2

moses. See g eneral i ndex

mottahedeh, m ildred, passing of, 323

moussa, kamaye, 344.1a

muhájir, raġmátu'ulláh (h and of the
cause of g od), 332.2; conference
dedicated to, 80.1–3

muġammad. See g eneral i ndex

muġammad, j ináb-i-Shah (Amínu'l-
bayán, T rustee of the b ayán),
21.18–20

muġammad-'Alí, mírzá. See g eneral
index

mühlschlegel, e lisabeth, 54.3, 97 .2e,
175.1

mühlschlegel, u rsula, 97 .4

muhtadí, h abíbu'lláh, 9.5

müller, f riedrich, 111.79

muller, m ax, 202.4

murphy, r ebequa, 344.1b

myungjung, kim, 54.3, 97 .2c, 207 .1c,
344.2a

Nádirí, Amír-ḡusayn, execution of,
37 .1–2

Nagaratnam, S., 97 .2c, 115.2

Najafabadi, h abibullah f erdosian,
297 .1, 297 .4

Najafabadi, h edayat-kashefi, 278.4,
280.7, 285.2, 285.4, 286.2, 286.3, 288.1, 289.6, 321.2–3, 341.2

Nakhjavání, 'Alí, 49.1, 152.1, 264.1Naráqí, Sírús, 97 .2d, 207 .1d, 344.1dNá'irí'd-dín Sháh,
21.21Nasirizadeh, Ataollah h amid, 278.4,
280.7, 285.2, 286.2, 286.3, 288.1, 289.6, 321.2–3, 341.2

Nassimova, d elafruz, 344.1c

Navídí, ‘Azíz (knight of b ahá’u’lláh),
 passing of, 34

Navváb (ásíyíh khánúm, m ost
 exalted leaf). See g eneral i ndex

Ndegwa, rachel, 344.1a

89i nDe x o f n a m e S

Neufeld, linda, 97 .2b

Niederreiter, leo, 97 .4Ni’mati, mr., 321.5Noguchi, lori, 344.1c

Öjermark, p aul, 344.1e

olyai, p erin, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 344.2a

o’m ara, p atrick, 54.3, 97 .2e, 207 .1e,
 344.1e

ong, r ose, 97 .2c, 207 .2

otmani, m uġammad, 207 .1a, 344.1a

parsa, Ahmad, 344.1a

páshá’í, b ihnám, execution of, 59.2–3

paymán, khudáraġm, 97 .4

perdu, Nabil, 97 .2e, 207 .1e, 344.2a

peres, Shimon, 23.4

philip, p rince (d uke of e dinburgh),
 42.1, 58.1–2, 188.1, 216.14

pihlainen, m aija, 207 .1e, 344.2a

pollock, g arth, 274.1, 344.1a

pringle, r uth, 97 .2b, 108.6, 207 .1b,
 344.2a

rafat, p olin, 97 .2e, 207 .1e, 344.2a

rahbar-p our, g holam-h ossein, 278.1

ramasamy, j aya g opan, 344.1c

ramirez, z enaida, 207 .1c, 329.1

ramoroesi, d aniel, 97 .2a, 207 .1a,
 344.2a

rashid, lateef, 344.1c

rassekh, Shapoor, 54.3, 97 .2e, 207 .1e,
 344.2a
 rawẏání, m asīẏ, 97 .4
 rawẏání, m ihrangíz, 139.6a
 rawẏání, rúẏu'lláh, execution of,
 276, 277, 278, 280.1–4, 280.6, 299.8
 razavi, riaz, 179.2–3, 179.8arazavi, Shahriar, 344.1erené, e lla, 186.2
 rené, f rance Albert, 186.1, 186.3
 rené, Sarah, 186.2
 reyhani, f oad, 344.1creyhani, m anijeh, 274.1, 344.1d
 reza'i, Shahram, martyrdom of,
 254.3–4c
 ríṣá, ḥájí Amín (T rustee of the
 huqúqu'lláh), 21.22
 ríṣá, j ináb-i-g hulám (Amín-i-Amín,
 T rustee of the T rustee), 21.23–24
 robarts, j ohn (h and of the cause of
 god), passing of, 112
 robert, g ilbert, 77 .1, 97 .2a, 180.1
 roberts, w illiam, 54.3, 97 .2b, 207 .2
 rogers, donald, 5 1.1, 54.1, 154.1, 267 .1
 rohani, c yrus, 207 .1c, 344.2a
 rohani, r uhollah, execution of,
 285.2, 285.3, 286.2, 288.4, 321.2
 root, m artha, 269.1, 300.1, 301.1
 ruhe, d avid S., 49.1, 142.1–2
 rúẏyyih khánum, Amatu'l-b ahá
 (hand of the cause of g od). See
 general i ndex
 rumi, m ustafa, 332.2
 rustamí, 'Atá'u'lláh, 139.5
 rustamí, rúẏu'lláh, 139.5
 Sabeti, Nahid, 284.2Sabri, i sobel, 51.1; passing of, 132

Sadeghian, carmen e lisa de, 207 .1b,
 344.1b

Ādúqí, Ayatu'lláh, 139.3, 155.2Sahba, f ariborz, 23.9, 64.2, 91.1

Samandarí, b ahman, 39.2; execution
 of, 127, 128.1–128.4

Samandari, m ihdi, 97 .4

Samandarí, r uzítá, 39.2, 41.3

Samaniego, v icente, 97 .2c, 207 .1c,
 338.6, 344.2a

Sanani, h ushmand, 284.2

Sánchez, i sabel de, 97 .2b, 207 .1b,
 344.2a

Saunders, b ruce, 97 .2d, 207 .1d,
 344.2a

Schaefer, u do, 111.1, 111.50

Schechter, f red, 97 .2b, 154.1, 216.34,
 267 .1

i nDe x o f n a m e S

80Schwerin, kimiko, 97 .2c, 154.1, 267 .1

Sealy, e rrol, 97 .2b, 207 .1b, 344.2a

Sears, w illiam (h and of the cause of
 god), passing of, 126

Semenoff, p aul, 97 .2e, 207 .2

Semple, i an, 49.1, 152.1, 264.1

Senoga, e dith, 97 .2a, 207 .1a, 344.2a

Serrano, Arturo, 97 .2b, 207 .1b, 344.1bSezgin, i lhan, 2.2, 97 .2e, 207 .1e,
 344.1e

Shabrukh, f idrus, martyrdom of, 1.1

Shádpúr, g hulám-ḥusayn, 139.5

Shahabi, e htesham, 288.3

Shandegi, Shamambakh, 179.8aSharifabadi, f arzad khajeh, 289.1,
 297 .1, 297 .4

Sharifi, m anouchahr, 284.2

Sharon, m oshe, 294.1a

Shayani, farhad, 156.1, 207 .1b, 344.2a

Sháyyiq, Abu'l-qásim, execution of,
19.1–2, 37 .2

Shoaie, c rystal, 344.1b

Shoghi, p ayman, 344.1c

Shoghi e ffendi. See g eneral i ndex

Simpson, h eather, 207 .1d, 344.1d

Smith, Alan, 97 .2b, 207 .2Smith, d avid r., 97 .2b, 207 .1b,
344.1b

Smith, m arilyn, 344.1b

Solano, leticia de, 344.1bSorabjee, z ena, 97 .2c, 207 .1c, 314,
331.20, 344.1c

Soraya, g eorge, 207 .1c, 344.1c

St. b arbe b aker, richard, 82.1, 90.5,
188.3

Stevenson, j oy, 51.1, 54.1, 154.1, 267 .1

Subhání, p aymán, martyrdom of, 1.2

Subhání, rúhu'l-Amín, martyrdom
of, 1.2

Sundram, chellie, 54.2Sundram, Shantha, 54.3, 97 .2c, 207 .2

Tafakkurí, þabíbu'lláh, 139.5Taherzadeh, Adib, 49.1, 54.1, 152.1,
264.1; passing of, 319

Tahzib, b ahiyyih, 75.1

Talebi, m usa, 239.1–4, 289.6

øálibí, bízhan, 5.1

Tamashiro, h enry, 344.1d

Tessema, Asfaw, 344.1aThoresen, lasse, 299.10Thorne, Adam, 54.2Tin, u So, 97 .4Tirandaz,
Nosrat, 207 .1e, 344.1eTomás, r odrigo, 97 .2b, 207 .1b,
344.1b

Towfigh, Nicola, 344.1eT ran, r osalie, 207 .1c, 338.6, 344.1c

Tsutskova, larissa g rigorjevna, 175.2,
207 .1e, 344.1e

ugaia, e rama, 207 .1d, 344.1d
 uransaikhan, b aatar, 344.1c
 vafá'í, mr. (of i sfahan), 59.7
 vaĤdat-NiĤámí, Sirru'lláh, martyrdom
 of, 1.1
 vajda, Tiberiu, 207 .1e, 344.2a
 varqá, Akhu'sh-Shahíd, 21.25
 varqá, 'Ali m uĤammad (h and of the
 cause of g od): bwc activities,
 216.15, 331.29; at counselors' meetings, 157 .1, 212.2, 350.2; at NSA inaugural conventions,
 108.6, 129.18, 181.11, 200.10; as T rustee of þuqúqu'lláh, 13.2, 21.2, 21.29–31, 62.2, 121.1b
 varqá, j ináb-i-'Azízu'lláh, 21.25
 varqá, j ináb- valíyu'lláh (h and of the
 cause of g od), 21.25–29
 varqá the martyr, 21.25
 vuyiya, p eter, 51.1, 54.1, 154.1;
 passing of, 271
 walker, p enny, 267 .1
 warren, lally, 207 .1a, 344.2a
 81i nDe x o f n a m e S
 warren, l ucretia m., 97 .2a
 weinberg, r obert, 75.1
 white, r obin, 207 .1d, 344.1d
 whyte, d orothy, 344.1b
 wolcott, charles, passing of, 15.1
 yazdani, f ereidoun, 344.1d
 yazdí, 'Azíz, 51.1
 youssefian, Sohrab, 97 .2e, 207 .1e,
 344.1ezabihi-m oghaddam, Sirus, 285.2,
 285.4, 286.2, 286.3, 288.1, 289.6,
 321.2–3
 zarqani, mr. and mrs. Abdul
 rahman, 186.2

zenimoto, m ichitoshi, 97 .4

zerbes, i vo, 344.1e

ziehi, Antoinette, 344.1a

zock, Tiat à, 207 .1a, 344.1a

zoroaster. See g eneral i ndex

8general i ndex

‘Abdu’l-b ahá: acceptance of, 355.5;

acquisition of apartment used in

france, 237, 249.4; as authorized

interpreter, 17 .1–2, 22.11, 52.2, 52.3, 52.6, 131.9, 145.13, 201.9a, 215.7, 255.10a, 283.3; as center of the covenant, 107 .6, 129.20, 131.9–10, 144.2–4, 145.13, 145.20; construction of Shrine of The báb, 36.2, 36.4a, 91.2, 129.13, 176.6; covenant-breakers in family of, 255.5a–6; as exemplar, 60.6, 145.13, 199.2,

209.3, 225.2; on inheritance, 229.12–22; in kitáb-i-‘Ahd, 177 .4; NSAs established by, 52.3; relations with i srael, 23.2;

on r evelation of b ahá’u’lláh,

201.9–10. See also Tablets of the divine p lan; w ill and Testament

of ‘Abdu’l-b ahá

Aboriginal peoples. See i ndigenous

peoples

Action, 331.2, 348.8; collective, 200.7,

216.37, 356.35a; lines of, 213.7, 221.4, 222.15, 263.10, 331.17, 348.15, 348.17, 348.18. See also individual initiative

Adamic c ycle, 22.10, 131.4

Administrative center, b ahá’í. See

bahá’í w orld center (bwc)

Administrative o rder, b ahá’í, 337;

acceptance of, 32.3–3a; authority of, 215.5, 337 .5; channels for criticism in, 60.32–36, 145.3; as child of covenant, 144.4, 145.3; collaboration in, 249.2; development of, 18.10, 18.12, 151.6, 183.18, 201.28, 216.35, 255.11, 348.2, 356.9; emergence from obscurity, 354.2; establishment of, 60.54, 176.4–5, 220.1; expansion and consolidation through, 90.2, 129.16–17; features of, 60.17, 60.22, 102.18, 111.51, 183.13, 250.3–4; individual believers and, 67; Nineteen d ay feast and, 69.7–

8; processes of, 60.6–10, 60.24; Shoghi e ffendi’s development of,

111.55–57, 111.59; w orld o rder

based on, 90.17, 90.20, 96.12, 201.13, 201.18–21a, 201.28, 250.3, 356.9. See also b ahá’í

administration; i nstitutions,

bahá'í; local Spiritual Assemblies;
 National Spiritual Assemblies; universal house of justice
 Administrative rights, deprivation of,
 122.5–6, 122.12–20, 247 .7–9, 250.18c, 257 .7
 Adultery, 205.3aAdvocates for African food Security,
 147 .2
 Afghanistan, teaching work in, 223.7Africa: acceptance of bahá'í faith in,
 162.6; alcohol consumption by bahá'ís in, 247 .3–13; Auxiliary
 general index
 8Africa: acceptance of bahá'í faith in,
 (continued)
 boards, 2.3; bahá'í communities
 in, 22.4–6, 116.2, 222.2–3; bahá'í
 radio station in, 23.8i; continental
 board of counselors, 54.2, 54.3,
 77 .1, 97 .2a, 156.1, 180.1–2, 207 .1a,
 274.1, 344.1a; entry by troops in, 181.9; european pioneers in, 221.3;
 four year plan goals, 222.1, 222.10–
 15; ISAs in, 222.5; NSAs in, 191.1,
 222.5; riḡván message for 1996,
 222, 247 .1; Six year plan pioneer
 goals, 71.3; social and economic development projects, 216.9; teaching work in, 247 .2; Three
 year plan pioneer goals, 161.5–8;
 tribal conflicts in, 222.7–8; u.S.
 bahá'ís of African descent traveling
 to, 220.9, 331.8; use of the arts in, 331.10; women in, 116, 147 .2. See
 also individual African countries
 Africa project (1951–53), 222.3
 Age of maturity, bahá'í, 273
 Age of Transition, 90.14, 108.2Aghsán, 177 .3–5AidS, statement on, 199'Akká (israel), 176.8
 Alaska, bahá'í community of, 220.11
 Albania: establishment of ISAs in,
 98.1; National Spiritual Assembly of, 121.1a, 129.18

Alcohol, prohibition against drinking,

206.4, 247 .3–13

American b ahá'í community, 60.3–4,

60.44, 220.9, 220.14, 331.8, 331.9. See also u nited States,

National Spiritual Assembly of

Americas: Auxiliary boards, 2.3;

continental board of counselors, 54.3, 54.4, 97 .2b, 156.1, 207 .1b, 274.1, 344.1b; Six y ear p lan

pioneer goals, 71.3; Three y ear

plan pioneer goals, 161.5–8Andaman and Nicobar i slands, b ahá'í

community of, 218.7

Angola, National Spiritual Assembly

of, 22.9, 121.1a, 129.18, 216.7

Antipodes, b ahá'í community of,

224.2–3

Apartheid, 6, 108.8Arc/ Ark. See m ount carmel p rojects

Archives. See h istorical documents;

international Archives b uilding

Arc p rojects f und: contributions to,

36.5, 176.2, 181.3, 216.3, 240.2–4, 248.16, 249.6; needs of, 20.5, 64.10, 66.1, 83.5, 98.2, 120.5, 160.1, 171.6–7, 204, 213.31, 303.2; progress reports, 105.2, 189, 193.1–2, 200.9

Arctic regions, 220.16,

221.6

Arctic Teaching conference (1996),

238

Area g rowth p rograms, 313.6, 331.23.

See also i ntensive programs of

growth

Armaments, reduction of, 356.10b,

356.11, 356.12a, 356.13a

Armenia, National Spiritual Assembly

of, 191.1, 200.10. See also r ussia,

georgia and Armenia, r egional

Spiritual Assembly of

Arts, the, 299.10; in b ahá'í centers,
246; compilation on, 282; in expansion and consolidation, 216.31, 331.10; at Nineteen d ay
feasts, 222.13; as worship, 60.24;
youth involvement in, 331.27

“Arts and Nature” p rogram (london),
58, 64.3

Ascension of ‘Abdu’l-b ahá, 129.28;
time of day to commemorate, 125.2

Ascension of b ahá’u’lláh, 144.2;
centenary of, 22.10, 64.9, 90.8–9, 90.11–12, 107 .2, 107 .4, 108.11c–d,
85g e n e r a l i n D e x

129.2, 129.19, 131, 151.1; time of
day to commemorate, 125.2

ASeAN y outh conference (Thailand):
messages to, 208, 346

Asia: Auxiliary boards, 2.3;
continental board of counselors, 2.2, 54.2–4, 97 .2c, 115.1, 156.1, 207 .1c, 274.1, 344.1c; h ands
of

the cause visiting, 90.3; NSAs in, 173.2, 191.1; Six y ear p lan

pioneer goals, 71.3; Three y ear

plan pioneer goals, 161.5–8. See

also T wo y ear p lan for eastern

europa and Asia (1990–92); and

individual Asian countries and regions

Asian b uddhist conference for p eace,
108.9

Asian i nternational b ahá'í y outh
conference (p akistan), message
to, 338

ásíyíh khánúm. See Navváb Assistants to Auxiliary board members.

See Auxiliary boards

Associations of b ahá'í Studies, 331.13

Australasia: Auxiliary boards, 2.3;

continental board of counselors, 54.3, 207 .1d, 274.1, 290, 293, 344.1d; f our y ear p lan goals, 224.10; Six y ear p lan pioneer goals, 71.3; Three y ear p lan pioneer goals, 161.6–8

Australia: bahá'í courses in schools, 299.9; continental board of counselors, 97 .2d; four year plan goals, 224.11; pilgrims from, 164.5; riḡván message for 1996, 224

Austria: f our y ear p lan goals, 236;

National Spiritual Assembly of, 269.3. See also g ermany and Austria, National Spiritual Assembly of

Authority: in b ahá'í community, 60.33–34, 183.31, 183.36–38; expression of, 183.42–44; skepticism regarding, 60.22. See also i nterpretation, authoritative;

laws, b ahá'í

Auxiliary boards, 64.7, 108.10;

appointment of, 2.1, 121.1; conferences, 299.11; at continental boards of counselors' conference (2001), 331.29, 344.5, 350.3, 351.2, 357 .2; continental pioneering committees and, 88.7; education of children and, 313.7; expansion of, 2.2–4, 108.10, 212.6e; financial support for, 213.31; f ive year p lan involvement, 344.4; f our y ear plan activities, 265.3; functions of, 207 .3, 213.25, 272.1, 337 .14, 350.5; individuals' relationship with, 60.33, 181.2, 348.8–10; intensive programs of growth and, 348.15; local communities' relationship with, 213.30; ISAs' collaboration with, 181.2, 183.15–20, 183.22–23, 212.6b, 212.6d, 213.22–25, 249.2, 331.6; maturation of, 129.12, 200.4; members not eligible for rbcs, 250.12f; message to, 350.4–9; Nineteen d ay feast promotion, 73.1–3; NSAs' collaboration with, 102.7, 181.2, 213.10, 249.2; rbcs' relationship with, 250.27a, 344.4; training institute assistance, 213.18, 213.19, 216.6, 216.28, 270.5, 310.6–8

Azerbaijan, National Spiritual Assembly of, 123.1c, 129.18

báb, The: acceptance of, 355.4–5;

declaration of, 144.4; dream of, 140.5c; transfer and interment of remains, 21.19, 36.2, 91.2, 176.6. See also Shrine of the báb

g e n e r a l i n D e x

86backbiting, 206.5

bahá'í administration, 102; acceptance
 of, 355.5; establishment of, 102.4;
 features of, 60.20, 81.2, 183.21, 331.6; growth of, 129.12, 230.4; role in society, 55.10, 90.19,
 183.33; unity in, 52.2, 183.32–
 32a; in the west, 164.3. See also
 Administrative order, bahá'í;
 institutions, bahá'í
 Bahá'í Administration (Shoghi
 effendi), 111.54
 bahá'í chair for world peace
 (university of Maryland), 85,
 90.5, 216.14
 bahá'í community, 99.6; authority
 in, 111.54–56, 183.31; culture of, 331.2; diversity in, 55.3–6, 90.16–17, 99.4–4a, 202.60;
 emergence from obscurity, 21.33, 181.3; example of, 14.3, 55.11, 56.5a, 149.18, 181.8, 220.6–7,
 338.3–4; government relations, 60.4; growth of, 2.3–4, 36.6, 151.6, 157.5, 172.1–3, 181.2, 256.2,
 295.4, 356.9; homosexuality in, 205; individual's relationship to, 337.4; international
 responsibilities for,
 272.7d–e; maturation of, 21.7, 60.43–47, 90.16, 99.6, 102.3–4, 120.3, 129.4–13, 200.4, 258.1, 313.7,
 331.5; malfunctioning in, 337.13; mission of, 64.12; rights and freedoms in, 60; strengthening,
 60.33, 151.8, 213.23, 227.6–8, 313.3–4; unity of, 6.3, 183.32–35, 212.5, 295.4. See also bahá'í
 international
 community; bahá'í life; bahá'í
 world community; laws, bahá'í;
 local bahá'í communities;
 membership, bahá'í; National
 bahá'í communities; individual
 believersbahá'í cycle, 129.2, 131.4, 255.11a
 bahá'í faith: acceptance of, 21.14,
 109.3, 111.22, 145.12, 162.6–7, 201.27, 355.4–6, 355.8; courses on in school systems, 348.6;
 example of, 202.1; growth of, 8.7,
 22.9, 29.4, 36.6, 38.2, 48.2, 48.4,
 129.5, 131.11, 146.2, 223.5–6, 258.1; Israel's recognition of, 23;
 leadership in, 255; power of, 4.3, 56.5, 60.4, 60.20; proclamation of, 18.5, 18.12, 83.6, 96.5a,
 129.6, 129.8–9, 130, 216.10, 216.33, 220.1, 331.9, 331.18; purpose of, 64.11, 99.4a, 176.4, 183.5,
 183.32; receptivity to, 120.2, 162.6–8a, 172.1–2, 181.6, 183.5, 217.6–7, 218.3, 218.8, 223.1, 223.5,
 233.5, 348.2; as State religion, 18.8a, 201.17a,

201.21a–22; study of, 157 .7, 169.2–4, 187, 215.3, 296.1; union of all peoples in, 96.3a, 176.3, 183.5, 183.29–35, 200.3; unity of, 52.2, 60.6, 60.34, 60.36, 145.14; as world religion, 111.74, 131.16, 314. See also b ahá'í

community; b ahá'í life; b ahá'í

Teachings; e mergence from

obscurity; e ntry by troops

bahá'í i nstitute of h igher e ducation

(bihe), 287 .3, 289.1–3, 297 .2, 299.8

bahá'í international community (bic):

“Arts and Nature” cosponsorship, 58, 64.3; defense of iranian bahá'ís,

22.5, 331.15; environmental work, 42.1, 129.9, 15 1.3, 188.3; external affairs work, 8, 76.4, 108.9, 15 1.11; financial support for, 240.5; four year plan activities,

331.19; jerusalem office, 23.8b;

lesser peace and, 357 .4; millennial

activities, 342.1, 342.6, 342.9;

87g e n e r a l i n D e x

NSAs' collaboration with, 8.4–6,

48.5, 61.1, 129.9; representative's visit to pacific islands, 279; Three

year plan activities, 216.13; uN's

relationship with, 8.2, 18.5, 61.1, 64.3, 147 .2, 263.8; web

site, 249.4. See also office for the

Advancement of women; office

of public information; office of

the environment; united Nations

office

bahá'í i nternational f und:

contributions to, 240, 249.6; needs of, 22.12, 120.5–7, 213.31–33, 303; support for training institutes, 231.3, 270.1a, 310.3. See also Arc p rojects f und;

international d eputization f und

bahá'í i nternational w omen's

conference (Nigeria), message to, 116

bahá'í life: characteristics of, 90.19,

183.33, 218.10, 236.3; living, 48.10, 183.10, 225.6, 248.6a. See also b ahá'í community

bahá'í principles. See b ahá'í Teachings

bahá'í publishers' conference

(london), message to, 40

bahá'í Scriptures: electronic versions

of, 184; illuminate all knowledge, 169.2–4, 209.3; preservation of, 166, 302.5–6; prophets in, 7.5; standard of presentation for, 281; study of, 64.11, 157.7, 181.4, 217.8, 248.5, 248.15, 283.7, 306, 338.2. See also interpretations of

bahá'í Scriptures; Translations of

bahá'í Scriptures

bahá'í State, 201.7–7c, 201.14a,

201.15a, 201.17a, 201.21a–22. See also world government; world

order of bahá'u'lláh

bahá'í Teachings: acceptance of, 109.5,

355.4; application of, 60.1, 96.8, 109.2, 200.1–3, 201.20–20a; for conflict resolution, 202; moral and ethical, 56.3–5a, 124, 149.13, 205.13, 205.14, 206; obedience to, 18.5, 138.9; study of, 169.5–8, 169.10–11b, 181.5, 187, 206.3, 331.2

Bahá'í World, The (series), reformatting

of, 170

“bahá'í world, The” (web site),

331.18

bahá'í world center (bwc):

correspondence from, 312; dangers to, 103.3; establishment of, 2.5, 176.5, 176.7–8, 176.10; financial support of, 240.6; historical documents at, 302, 305.4, 305.11; ḥuququ'lláh's importance for, 21.4, 345.3; israel's recognition

of, 23; rbc's communication with, 250.25–25d; research

department, 36.4c, 192.2, 192.7;

Twelve month plan, 357.5;

youth service at, 129.11. See also center for the Study of the Texts; international Archives building;

international bahá'í library;

international Teaching center;

mount carmel projects; Seat of

universal house of justice; Shrine

of The Báb

bahá'í world commonwealth,

99.4b–c, 176.8, 201.17a, 201.22, 201.26a, 296.7, 356.19a. See also world government; world order

of bahá'u'lláh

bahá'í world community: development

of, 22.12, 32.2–6, 54.5, 123.5, 212.2; governance in, 111.20, 275.1; maturation of, 22.3, 146.1, 216.8, 216.18; recognition of, 8.6, 23.2, 48.2, 111.36; unity of, 6.3, 27.2, 202.3, 216.3. See also Administrative order,

general index

88bahá'í world community: development

(continued)

bahá'í; bahá'í community; bahá'í

international community

bahá'í world News Service (bwNS,

web site), 357.4

bahá'u'lláh: acceptance of, 32.2–4,

96.11, 99.5, 109, 149.18, 151.8,

355.4–5; emblazoning the Name of, 90.11, 107.8–9, 108.11e, 129.26–27, 144.6–7, 151.1; family of, 7.9, 36.2, 176.6, 177.3–5, 255.5a–6; infallibility of, 12.2–9; influence of, 99.8a, 131.12–14; love for, 162.7; on mt. carmel, 36.1, 91.2; proclamation to kings

and rulers, 60.12, 129.6; purpose of, 29.2, 129.24, 144.2, 145.13, 145.15–16, 356.19a; station of, 129.25–26, 131.4–5, 140, 149.18, 355.4; sufferings of, 131.6–7. See also Ascension of bahá'u'lláh;

bahá'í faith; greatest Name;

revelation of bahá'u'lláh; world

order of bahá'u'lláh

Bahá'u'lláh (office of public

information), 107.8–9, 108.11e

bahíyyih khánúm (greatest holy

leaf), 7.9; monument to, 36.2, 176.6

bahjí, new visitors center at, 331.7

bangladesh: bahá'í community of,

218.5; message to first bahá'í

National congress in, 143

beards, laws regarding length of,

165.4a

behavior, bahá'í standards of, 206.3–5

belarus, National Spiritual Assembly

of, 191.1, 200.10. See also ukraine, belarus and moldova, regional Spiritual Assembly of bible, 7.5, 281.4

bolivia: indigenous teaching conference in, 308; social and economic development in, 331.14. See also universidad Núr bophuthatswana. See South Africa, National Spiritual Assembly of

bosnia, teaching work in, 236.4brazil: bahá'í courses in schools, 299.9; international exposition on education for peace, 108.9; seventy-fifth anniversary of bahá'í faith in, 233, 249.4

british isles. See united kingdom

budapest (hungary), bic office in, 64.2

buddha, 7.5

bulgaria: ISAs established in, 98.1; National Spiritual Assembly of, 121.1a, 129.18

burundi, National Spiritual Assembly of, 216.34

businesses, private, 167, 245

cambodia: bahá'í community of, 219.6, 219.7; National Spiritual Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11; teaching work in, 216.7

cameroon, social and economic development projects, 331.14

canada: bahá'í community of, 183.11, 220.12, 339.1–2; National Spiritual Assembly of, 8.6; pioneers from, 331.8. See also united States and canada, National Spiritual Assembly of

candor, 183.40–42capacity building, 331.14, 331.17 .

See also human resources, development of; people of

capacity, teaching; Training institutes
 caribbean, the: european pioneers in,
 221.3; 1996 riḫvān message for,
 217
 caucasus, four year plan in, 223.4–5
 cause of bahá'u'lláh. See bahá'í faith
 89general index
 cause of god. See bahá'í faith
 censorship, 72.2, 118.6. See also
 prepublication review
 center for the Study of the Texts
 (building), 36.4c; commencement
 of, 83.4, 129.13, 151.11, 174; progress reports, 108.11b, 113.2, 114.3–4, 114.7, 160.1, 193.2, 216.2,
 249.5, 299.3
 center for the Study of the Texts
 (institution), 357 .10
 center of the covenant. See 'Abdu'l-
 bahá
 central Asia: four year plan in,
 223.4–9; NSA's inaugural convention, 129.18; regional
 Spiritual Assembly of, 123.1a, 173.2, 181.11; riḫvān message for
 1996, 223
 centralization, 183.26, 183.46–48,
 250.1, 250.4–5, 250.6e
 Century of Light (uhj), 354, 357 .3
 chad, training institute in, 299.5chair for bahá'í Studies (hebrew
 university of jerusalem), 294
 chair for bahá'í Studies (university of
 indore), 90.5
 charities, 35.4–5, 177 .2–3, 177 .5chastity, 205.13; compilation on, 56children: behavior of,
 149.14–15,
 273.1; education of, 200.4, 217 .5, 218.12, 223.7, 224.6, 248.11–15, 313.7; equality of men and
 women and, 7 .2, 7 .8, 7 .11; prevention of violence against, 149; registration of in iran, 325;

spiritual education of, 28, 149.19–19a, 219.4, 299.7, 331.24–28, 338.5, 348.5–6, 357 .3; women as primary educators of, 116.1. See also junior youth, bahá'í; youth,

bahá'í

children's classes: as four year plan

goal, 348.17; importance of, 213.23, 222.13, 348.6; ISAs and, 73.1a, 234.5, 295.3; in mongolia, 219.8; training teachers for, 216.6, 313.7, 331.25, 348.7, 357 .3–4; youth as teachers of, 213.33, 218.12

china: Amatu'l-bahá ruhíyyih

khánúm in, 90.3; international

book fair, 23.8g; pilgrims from, 164.5; proclamation of bahá'í

faith in, 23.8h

chinese believers, 219.4, 219.10christ, 140.2, 140.5c, 201.2a;

infallibility of, 12.6a

christianity, 201.21a; celebrating holy

days of, 10; Scriptures of, 7 .5, 281.4

ciskei. See South Africa, National

Spiritual Assembly of

city of the covenant. See New york

city, as city of the covenant

civil disorder, bahá'ís'

noninvolvement in, 6.9. See also politics, partisan, bahá'ís'

noninvolvement in

civilization. See world civilization

clergy, abolition of, 215.4, 225.4,

337 .6

clothing, laws regarding, 165.4aclug (romania), election of ISA in, 90.2

clusters, 348.11collective security, 108.3, 356.13a,

356.27–27a, 356.37a. See also Action, collective

commission on human rights (uN),

efforts for bahá'ís in iran, 22.5,

90.6

committee on the Status of women

(uN), 147 .2

communal harmony group (india),

331.10

communications. See internet, the;

media

communism, collapse of, 129.5,

129.11, 129.14

general index

850compilations: on the arts, 282; on

bahá'í elections, 81; on bahá'í

scholarship, 195; on chaste and

holy life, 56; on conservation, 76; on covenant of bahá'u'lláh, 45;

on crisis and victory, 38; on entry

by troops, 172, 181.9, 200.4; on

fasting, 336; on puqúqu'lláh, 13.4, 324.4; on internal opposition, 296; on Nineteen day feast, 70.5; on obligatory

prayer, 336; on teaching people of capacity, 94; on trustworthiness, 14; on use of media, 130; on women, 7.8, 307.3–4

conference on environment and

development (rio de janeiro),

194.1

conflict resolution, 60.31, 96.7,

108.3, 202. See also consultation,

bahá'í; politics, partisan, bahá'ís'

noninvolvement in

congo republic: media campaign in,

331.9; National Spiritual Assembly of, 121.1a, 129.18

conservation, 42, 96.9, 188.1–3,

216.14; compilation on, 76. See also environment, the; Network

on conservation and religion

consolidation, 57.1, 103.3, 151.3,

191.4, 212.6c, 216.9. See also deepening; expansion and

consolidation; Training institutes

consultation, bahá'í: in bahá'í

administration, 67 .3–7, 90.19; in marriage, 149.6, 149.9; principle of, 6.8, 55.10, 60.27–31, 60.41, 96.7; via the i nternet, 203.3–5,

203.7

continental b ahá'í f unds, 54.4;

support for training institutes, 231.3–4, 270.1a–5, 310.3, 310.4, 310.8continental boards of counselors,

349; accomplishments of, 64.7, 90.4, 97 .6; appointment of, 2, 54.1–3, 77, 97, 115, 156, 175, 180, 207, 274, 293, 344; conferences, 23.8a, 97 .7, 100.2, 101.1, 207 .4,

216.6, 299.2, 299.11, 331.6,

331.29, 344.5, 351; continental pioneering committees and,

88.6–8, 88.10, 343.4; f ive year

plan activities, 344.4, 357 .2; f our

year p lan activities, 210, 212,

213.2–34, 265.1–3; functions of, 103.3, 157 .6, 183.14–17, 200.4, 212.6a, 213.9–12, 215.7, 272.1, 272.3–6, 337 .14; increase in number of, 2.4, 207 .1; iT c's

relationship with, 272.7a–b; local communities' relationship with, 60.33, 102.7, 181.2, 213.30; ISAs' collaboration with, 249.2; maturation of, 129.12, 200.4; messages to, 103.2, 209, 265, 348, 350; NSAs' collaboration with, 23.8c, 103.2–3, 138.3–4, 151.11, 157 .4–5, 157 .8, 183.12–25, 212.6b, 213.6–7, 213.24, 249.2, 313.6, 331.6; pioneers' relationship to, 243; rank of, 183.21; rbc's' relationship with, 250.6c, 250.20, 250.22, 250.27–27a, 299.6, 344.4; Spiritual Assemblies' collaboration with, 102.7, 181.2, 344.4; training institute assistance, 212.6c, 213.18, 216.27, 310.4, 310.6, 310.8, 331.4; women on, 52.8. See also Auxiliary boards

continental p ioneer committees, 88,

157 .9, 243.3, 272, 343. See also international d eputization f und

convention on the e limination of all

forms of d iscrimination against

women (uN), 307 .9

851g e n e r a l i n D e x

conventions, b ahá'í: international,

121c, 129.17, 249.7, 265.2, 299.2;

national, 30, 81.3, 183.40–41, 185, 196.2, 196.5, 300, 301

conversions. See m ass conversions

convocation of world leaders, 18.2,

18.12, 31.1–2, 31.4, 200.2, 356.11–13a

cook i slands, visit of prime minister

to bwc, 4, 158

corruption, 60.22, 145.10, 149.16,

205.6

covenant-breakers, 251.7, 255.4–8,

272.3, 272.7c, 355.12–13

covenant of b ahá'u'lláh, 60.54;

'Abdu'l-b ahá as center of, 107 .6,

129.20, 131.9–10, 144.2–4, 145.13, 145.20; centenary of inception of, 22.10, 45.2, 48.7, 90.10–12, 107 .2, 107 .5–6, 108.11c, 108.11e, 144.1–2, 145, 151.1; compilation on, 45; divine guidance from, 215.5; firmness in, 109.4, 151.9, 201.27, 220.4, 355.5; ĩuqúqu'lláh's importance to, 21.5, 345.4, 345.7; power of, 48.12, 146.3, 201.9–10; proclamation of, 146.1; study of, 107 .5–6, 138.7, 225.7; unifying force of, 52.2, 60.6, 60.36, 145.14. See also d ay

of the covenant, messages for

crisis and victory, 18.7, 36.6, 151.13,

296.11; compilation on, 38

criticism, 60.32–36,

183.46

croatia. See Slovenia and c roatia,

regional Spiritual Assembly of

czech and Slovak r epublics, r egional

Spiritual Assembly of, 258.4, 258.6

czechoslovakia: establishment of

ISAs in, 98.1; National Spiritual Assembly of, 105.1, 108.5, 108.6czech r epublic, National Spiritual

Assembly of, 258.6, 269.3

day of the covenant, messages for,

121, 145

decentralization, 183.26, 183.46–48,

250.1, 250.4–5, 250.6e

declarations of faith, acceptance of,

78.3–5

deepening, 18.5, 162.7–9, 213.14,

219.7, 221.8, 222.12. See also consolidation; T raining institutes

deforestation, halting, 188.1–3

democracy, b ahá'í administration as,

337

deputization: by i ranian b ahá'ís,

248.9a–10; for training institute teachers, 231.3–4, 270, 310. See also international deputization

fund

devotional meetings, 216.26, 315.7, 348.17

dispensation of b ahá'u'lláh, 131.4. See also b ahá'í cycle

disunity, 29.3, 145.9, 203.4. See also unity

diversity, 55.3–6, 90.16–17, 99.4–4a, 202.6c

divine plan, 201.11a, 216.39, 217.8, 263.10; unfoldment of, 22.11, 129.17, 223.1, 263.10. See also major plan of god; minor plan of god; Tablets of the divine plan

earrings, laws regarding wearing of, 165.1, 165.4

earth Summit (rio de janeiro), 194.2

east, the: laws binding in, 164.3–4; origins of all religions in, 7.3–4

eastern bloc countries: b ahá'í faith in, 129.5, 162.6; first new ISA in, 90.2; pioneer goals, 24, 71.1, 71.8, 84.3; teaching work in, 23.8h,

general index

852eastern bloc countries: b ahá'í faith (continued)

120.2, 216.7; youth activities in, 129.11. See also Two year plan for eastern europe and Asia (1990–92)

eastern europe: establishment of ISAs in, 90.2, 98.1; teaching work in, 61.1. See also Two year plan for eastern europe and Asia

economic and Social council (united

Nations), bic 's consultative status
with, 8.2
economic problems, 129.14; spiritual
solutions to, 21.5, 21.9, 21.15, 345.4
ecuador, social and economic
development in, 331.14
education: in Africa, 222.9; of
children, 200.4, 217 .5, 218.12, 223.7, 224.6, 248.11–15, 313.7; discipline within, 149.14–15;
human rights, 253.1, 331.17; importance of, 141.3c, 205.6–6a; for peace, 85, 90.5, 108.9;
spiritual, 28, 149.19–19a, 219.4, 299.7, 331.24–28, 338.5, 348.5–6, 357 .3; of youth, 141.3a, 357 .3.
See also b ahá'í f aith,
study of; b ahá'í Scriptures, study
of; children's classes; literacy, promotion of
egypt, b ahá'í community in, 222.3
elections, b ahá'í, 102, 196, 232,
337 .7–9; compilation on, 81; minority preference in tie votes, 6.3–4; voting age, 78.2. See also
conventions, b ahá'í
emergence from obscurity, 2.3–4,
38.3–4, 44.5, 60.42–47, 85.3, 108.9, 176.9, 212.7, 223.1, 354.2; external affairs work and, 8.1, 29.8,
46.2, 90.19, 331.6; i ranian
persecutions and, 176.9, 216.40;
in Six y ear p lan, 22.1, 22.4–6encouragement, 183.46–48
endowments, disposition of, 177 .2–3,
177 .5
england. See u nited kingdom
enrollments: high levels of, 64.1, 90.2,
90.15, 331.3; increasing, 18.4,
22.9, 57, 213.15, 219.9, 222.12;
procedures for, 78.1–4; Six y ear
plan, 129.5
entry by troops: acceleration of, 57 .1,
64.11, 90.15, 90.18, 248.10; in Africa, 181.9, 222.10–12; in central Asia, 223.5–7; compilation on,
172, 181.9, 200.4; in e urope, 221.7; evidences
of, 36.6, 48.3, 64.1; in North America, 220.15–16; training institutes' role in, 331.3, 331.5–6,
348.5; youth involvement in, 338.2. See also e xpansion and

consolidation; mass conversions

entry by troops, advancing process

of: in Asia, 219.2, 223.1; in four
year plan, 212.4, 212.7, 213.4,
216.17–29, 217 .2, 218.1, 236, 249.8, 263.1, 348.3, 357 .7; in india, 218.3, 218.14; at local
level, 213.22; in pacific region,
224.3; systematic, 263.10; training institutes and, 220.2–3, 236.2

environment, the, 82.2, 96.9, 129.14,
188.1–3, 194.2; compilation on, 76. See also conservation

equality of women and men: in
Africa, 116, 222.9; bahá'í
principle of, 7, 149.7, 187 .6, 218.11, 337 .16; differentiation of functions, 7 .9, 307 .9; as
prerequisite for peace, 110.1. See also men; office for the

Advancement of women; women

era of fulfillment, 22.10

eritrea, National Spiritual Assembly
of, 191.1, 200.10

85 general index

ethiopia, social and economic
development projects, 331.14

europa: Auxiliary boards, 2.2, 2.3;

bahá'í faith in, 162.7, 299.10;

continental board of counselors,
2.2, 54.2, 54.3, 97 .2e, 207 .1e,
344.1e; external affairs work in, 48.5; four year plan pioneer
goals, 221.4–10; hands of the
cause visiting, 90.3; National
Spiritual Assemblies (NSAs), 191.1; regional Spiritual
Assemblies, 173.2; rixvân
message for 1996, 221; Six year
plan pioneer goals, 71.3; Ten year
world crusade in, 221.1; Three
year plan pioneer goals, 161.5–7;

youth conferences of 1994, 182. See also individual European countries and regions
 european b ahá'í youth council, 75,
 129.11, 221.3, 252, 291
 european union (eu): resolutions on
 bahá'ís in iran, 288.6
 expansion and consolidation:
 acceleration of, 48.3, 71.4, 90.4, 213.16–17, 216.18–19, 216.27, 217.4–8, 219.3; of Administrative order, 129.16–17; in Africa, 222.10–13; in cambodia, 219.7; in central Asia, 223.5–7; four year plan, 331.8; iT c's responsibilities for, 272.7e; large-scale, 218.1, 218.5, 263.11; local plans of, 108.10, 213.19, 213.22–24; sustaining, 90.16, 213.31, 263.11, 348.2; systematic, 313.6, 313.7, 348.13; Three year plan activities, 216.4–8; training institutes and, 223.7, 299.6; use of arts for, 216.31; youth involvement in, 218.12, 252.2. See also b ahá'í
 faith, growth of; entry by troops;
 mass conversion
 external affairs work: advancement of, 8, 147.3, 200.4; consultations on, 61; four year plan activities, 216.33, 222.13, 299.8–9, 313.4, 331.6, 331.15–18, 348.2; Six year plan activities, 48.4–5, 129.6–10; Three year plan activities, 216.4, 216.11–14; Twelve month plan activities, 357.4. See also b ahá'í
 international community;
 emergence from obscurity,
 external affairs work and
 families, 60.48; covenant-breakers in, 255.5–8; preservation of, 222.8; prevention of violence in, 149; spiritual enrichment of, 219.7; teaching b ahá'í faith to, 218.11.
 See also b ahá'u'lláh, family of
 fasting, 21.14; compilation on, 336;
 laws regarding, 315.3–5, 324.3, 324.6, 352.1
 finland: b ahá'í courses in schools, 299.9; peace conference in, 31.1

five year plan (2001–2006), 313.5–6,
 344.4, 348, 357 .2, 357 .7–11
 forests, preservation of, 188.1–3
 formative Age: centenary of
 inception, 357 .7; duration of, 356.20–20a; fifth epoch,
 351.4–5, 357 .2, 357 .9; fourth
 epoch, 21.32, 22.1, 23.8, 108.9,
 129.4, 157 .5, 183.18, 210.3, 345.6; unfolding of, 216.35, 331.5, 331.22
 fourth international dialogue on
 the Transition to global Society
 (maryland), 216.14
 fourth world conference on women
 (beijing), 147 .2, 194.1, 216.13
 four year plan (1996–2000), 216.16–
 42, 248.2–3; accomplishments of, 234.3, 249.1–7, 258, 263.1–6, 299.1–11, 313.2–4, 331.1–22,
 general index
 85four year plan (1996–2000)
 (continued)
 344.4, 348.1–2, 348.4,
 357 .3; continental boards
 of counselors' involvement
 in, 212, 265; financial needs,
 213.31–32; goals of, 213.33,
 217 .2–8, 218.9–15, 221.7, 236.2, 248.10, 263.12–13, 331.5; individual's role in, 216.21–22,
 263.12–16; involvement
 in, 272.5–6; national plans for, 213.5–7, 213.13–25; preparations for, 210.1, 213. See also entry
 by troops, advancing process of; pioneers, four year plan;
 Training institutes; and also under
 individual countries and regions
 france, acquisition of apartment used
 by 'Abdu'l-bahá, 237, 249.4
 freedom(s): academic, 296.8;
 authority as aspect of, 60.34; of expression, 60.1, 60.24–27, 60.31–36, 60.45, 60.48–52, 72.2, 72.4,
 118.4–5, 183.42, 201.27; individual, 60, 102.15, 201.22–25; of religion, 111.3–4a, 111.37–38,

111.68; of religious association, 111.4b, 111.37–47, 111.75–76; true, 60.53–56, 109.3
 free will, 60.5, 60.20, 60.49, 145.12
 french canadian believers, 220.16
 french p olynnesia, teaching work in,
 224.12
 fundamentalism, religious, 26.9,
 129.14, 202.4, 263.9
 fund-raising activities, acceptable,
 35.4–5
 funds, b ahá'í, 35, 120, 151.12, 163,
 171, 213.32, 216.3, 222.12. See also b ahá'í i nternational
 fund; continental b ahá'í f und;
 þuqúqu'lláh; local b ahá'í f unds;
 National b ahá'í f undsgabriel (angel), 140.5b, 140.5c
 genocide convention (u.S.), 44.7
 georgia, National Spiritual Assembly
 of, 191.1, 200.10. See also r ussia,
 georgia and Armenia, r egional
 Spiritual Assembly of
 germany: government recognition of
 bahá'í community, 108.5, 111;
 interfaith activities in, 331.20; National Spiritual Assembly of, 102.6, 111.10, 111.17
 germany and Austria, National
 Spiritual Assembly of, 221.1
 ghana, use of the arts in, 331.10
 girls: education of, 222.9; equality of
 women and men and, 7 .2, 7 .11
 god: involvement in history, 60.10;
 knowledge of, 12.11a, 21.14, 145.15, 205.7; love for, 205.7; manifestations' relationship with,
 109.4, 140, 203.5a; mankind's relationship with, 108.2, 145.16, 263.5, 296.6, 345.4; obedience to,
 205.7; purpose of, 64.11, 108.2, 145.7, 176.10; sovereignty of, 60.5, 145.12. See also m ajor p lan
 of god; m inor p lan of g od
 godlessness, 90.14, 99.2a, 183.27,

331.24

golden Age of b ahá'í f aith, 55.4,

108.2, 216.38, 248.2, 331.22

government(s): b ahá'í concepts of,

29.8, 201.26; existing systems of, 60.10; influencing, 44, 201.7; loyalty and obedience to, 79.2, 122.7; NSAs' relations with, 79, 120; opposition to, 60.22; uhj relations with, 4.1, 23.8f, 44.3–4, 200.8. See also b ahá'í State;

convocation of world leaders; Separation of church and state; world government

greatest h oly leaf. See b ahíyyih

khánum

855g e n e r a l i n D e x

greatest Name, 131.4, 229.6a–7a;

laws regarding recitation of, 315.3,

315.6. See also b ahá'u'lláh

greenland: b ahá'í community of,

220.13; e uropean pioneers in,

221.3; National Spiritual Assembly of, 121.1a, 129.18

growth. See b ahá'í community,

growth of; b ahá'í f aith, growth

of; e xpansion and consolidation;

intensive programs of growth

guardians: as authorized interpreters,

17 .3, 192.4–5, 215.7, 251.4–5, 251.9, 283.3; functions of, 255.8; infallibility of, 192.4–5. See also Shoghi e ffindi

guardianship: references in kitáb-i-

Aqdas, 177; restricted to men, 7 .9; succession issues, 255.1–10

guinea, National Spiritual Assembly

of, 22.9

guinea-b issau, National Spiritual

Assembly of, 22.9, 64.5

guyana: National Spiritual Assembly

of, 79.1–2; social and economic development projects, 331.14; teaching work in, 129.5

hair, laws regarding length of, 165.1,

165.3

hands of the cause of g od:

appointment of, 111.55; custodianship of, 144.5–6; functions of, 90.3, 183.15, 215.7, 350.5; residing in h oly land,

36.4b; women as, 52.8

harmony, communal, 202.6–7,

331.10. See also u nity

hawaii, f our y ear p lan in, 224.11

heroic Age, 181.9

hindus, conflicts with m uslims,

202.1, 202.4

hispanic believers, 220.16

historical documents: in b ahá'í community, 305.12–14; at bwc, 302, 305.4, 305.11; prepublication review of, 305.15, 305.18; publication of, 305.7, 305.9–18; translations into english, 305.7 . See also Scholars /

scholarship, b ahá'í

holy d ays, b ahá'í, 10.2b–4, 125

holy Spirit, 140.3, 140.5a–b, 151.2,

183.45, 206.1b, 248.5, 283.8a

holy y ear (1992–93), 64.8, 90.7,

107, 129.2–4, 129.15–27, 145.19; accomplishments of, 151.1–5, 216.1. See also Ascension of bahá'u'lláh, centenary

of; covenant of b ahá'u'lláh,

centenary of inception of; w orld

congress, second

homefront pioneers, 24.3, 343.2,

348.12, 357 .8

homosexuality, 124, 205

hong k ong: b ahá'í community

of, 219.10; o ffice of p ublic

information in, 64.2

house of 'Abdu'llah páshá, restoration

of, 92.1

houses of j ustice, 201.7a, 201.13a.

See also local h ouses of j ustice;

National houses of justice;
 universal house of justice
 houses of worship. See mashriqu'l-
 Adhkár(s)
 humanity. See mankind
 human resources, development of,
 151.9, 181.5, 218.13, 263.11, 265.4; in four year plan, 313.3,
 331.14, 331.17; in Six year plan,
 138.2, 151.7; in Three year plan,
 200.6. See also Training institutes
 human rights, 29.8, 194.1, 253.1,
 331.17. See also rights
 hungary: establishment of ISAs in,
 98.1; National Spiritual Assembly of, 121.1a, 129.18, 269.3
 general index
 856puqúqu'lláh: amount directed to work
 on Terraces, 98.2; compilation
 on, 13.4, 324.4; computation and payment of, 21.5, 21.10, 21.12, 345.4, 345.9, 345.11;
 conference on (1987), 13; deputies and representatives of,
 62.2; development of, 21.12–33; provision for in wills, 229.9–10; as right of god, 21.5, 163.3,
 345.3,
 345.4; world order of bahá'u'lláh
 and, 21.4, 345.3–4. See also law of puqúqu'lláh; Trustee of puqúqu'lláh
 hypocrisy, 206
 immorality, 124.2a, 205.3, 205.4a,
 205.16–17. See also morality,
 decline of
 Importance of Obligatory Prayer and
 Fasting, The, 336
 Importance of the Arts in Promoting the
 Faith, The, 282
 incest, 149.16
 independent investigation of truth,
 109.2–4, 169.5a, 263.8

india: absorption of Sikkim into NSA,
129.17; b ahá'í community of,
218.2–4, 219.4; interfaith activities in, 314, 331.20; m ashriqu'l-
Adhkár in, 22.8, 23.8h, 64.3,
129.6, 331.9; riḡván m essage
for 1996, 218; Supreme court ruling re: b ahá'í f aith, 202; youth
conference in, 347
indigenous believers, 216.7, 217 .3,
219.4, 222.12, 224.4, 308
indigenous peoples: conservation and,
42.1; plight of, 29; rights of, 46, 55.7–9; service to, 295; teaching work among, 25.2, 55, 217 .3,
221.6, 238.1
individual, the: rights and freedoms of,
60, 102.15, 201.22–25; self-worth of, 6.5, 205.6–7; transformation of, 138.9, 183.32a, 227 .5–7 ,
331.3; two duties of, 355.3
individual believers, 151.13; American,
183.3–11; Auxiliary boards' relationship with, 181.2, 348.8–10; community's relationship to,
337 .4; development of, 18.5, 212.4, 212.7, 213.4, 215.7, 216.17–22, 230; enhancing faith of, 13.2,
138.2, 151.7, 151.8, 200.6, 212.5; in f ive year p lan, 348.3;
in four y ear p lan, 222.11, 234.3,
234.6, 248.3; importance of puqúqu'lláh for, 21.5; institutions' relationship with, 60.5, 60.18,
96.5, 157 .5, 207 .3, 220.7, 337 .13; interpretations by, 12.3, 12.10, 17, 283.7; ISAs' relationship
with, 60.19–20, 200.7, 222.11; Nineteen d ay feast and, 69.10;
responsibilities of, 21.14, 67; Spiritual Assemblies' relationship with, 25.3, 183.35–48, 206.2–4;
teaching by, 22.5, 89.1, 90.12, 200.11–12, 212.5–6, 216.20, 220.8, 225, 310.4, 310.5, 313.3,
348.8–10; translations of b ahá'í
Scriptures, 192.3, 302.6–7, 304.3–5, 305.2–3, 305.7; true, 60.30. See also h uman resources,
development of
individual initiative: fostering, 102.15,
181.4, 183.36–37, 183.46–47, 216.22, 224.3; stifling, 183.26; systematic, 263.10, 263.12–16,
384.8–10; in teaching, 313.2–3
indonesia: f our y ear p lan in, 224.9;
restoration of NSA, 332, 357 .6
infallibility, 12
inheritance: b ahá'í laws on, 229.2–3a,
229.4, 229.9, 307 .9; quotes from 'Abdu'l-b ahá regarding, 229.12–22

institute for higher bahá'í Studies, 297 .2–3

857g e n e r a l i n D e x

institute for Studies in g lobal

prosperity (india), 357 .4

institutions, 60.22, 145.6, 145.9–11

institutions, b ahá'í: application of

bahá'í law, 149.18; appointed,

183.13, 25 1.11, 337 .14; authority of,

32.3–3a, 183.36–38; collaboration among, 263.12; elected, 183.13, 183.36, 330.2–2a; establishment of, 90.14, 176.4–5, 176.8–9; in five year plan, 348.3; in four year

plan, 222.11, 234.3; functioning of,

131.11, 138.2, 200.6–8, 201.26–26a; individuals' relationship with, 96.5, 60.5, 60.18, 157 .5, 207 .3, 220.7 , 337 .13; maturation of, 18.4, 18.7–8, 22.1–2, 29.6, 212.4–5, 212.7 , 213.4, 216.17–19, 230, 337 .4; qualities for service on, 232.3–4, 232.6; responsibilities of, 141.3c, 141.4, 141.7; role in society, 90.19–20, 96.8, 201.7; safeguards for, 60.22; teaching role, 225.7; women's participation in, 52.4a, 52.7 , 52.8, 307 .6–7 . See

also Administrative order, bahá'í;

Auxiliary boards; continental

boards of counselors; hands of the

cause; puqúqu'lláh; local Spiritual

Assemblies; National Spiritual Assemblies; Spiritual Assemblies; universal house of justice

integration and disintegration,

processes of, 129.14, 145.4–6, 145.8, 151.3, 183.8, 200.3, 216.36, 263.4–5, 263.8–9, 331.21. See also o ld world order,

breakdown of

intensive programs of growth, 348.11–

19, 357 .8

inter-Assembly collaboration p rojects,

71.1, 138.6

international Archives b uilding, 36.2,

176.7international Archives b uilding,

extension to: commencement of, 83.4, 108.11b; construction of, 36.4d, 174; progress reports, 113.2, 114.3–4, 129.13, 151.11, 216.2, 299.3

international b ahá'í library, 36.4e,

129.13

international book fair (china), 23.8g

international conference on

population and development

(cairo), 194.1

international deputization fund,

89.1; access to, 88.2, 88.6, 88.8; contributions to, 89.4, 89.6; oversight of, 89.5, 272.2f, 343.3; support for training institute teachers, 310.4

international development. See Social

and economic development projects

international exposition on education

for peace (brazil), 108.9

international literacy year (uN,

1990), 68.6

international Teaching center

(building), 36.4b, 129.13, 151.11; inauguration of, 331.29, 344.5, 350; progress reports, 193.2, 216.2, 249.5, 299.3

international Teaching center (iTc,

institution), 64.7; appointment of members, 51, 54.4, 154, 267, 329; continental boards of counselors' relationship with, 90.4, 272.7a–b; continental pioneering committees and, 88.6,

89.5, 272.7f, 343.3; four year

international Teaching center

plan activities, 299.2; functions

of, 36.4b, 157.3–9, 216.32, 272; influences of, 200.4; maturation of, 129.12; meetings of, 53; Three year plan activities, 216.6; training

general in De x

858international Teaching center

(continued)

institute assistance, 331.4; twenty-

fifth anniversary of, 272.1, 275; uhj consultations with, 157, 181.2; women on, 52.8

internet, the: bahá'í sites on, 249.4,

331.18, 357.4; opposition to bahá'í

faith on, 296.2–3; postings on,

203

interpretations of bahá'í Scriptures:

authoritative, 251.3, 251.4–5, 251.9; individual, 12.3, 12.10, 17, 283.7 . See also ‘Abdu’l-b ahá,
as authorized interpreter; Shoghi effendi, as authorized interpreter

iran: desecration of b ahá’í cemeteries

in, 133; education in, 68.4; registration of b ahá’í marriages

in, 325; registration of b ahá’í

properties in, 21.24

iranian b ahá’ís: arrests of, 39, 41,
284.2, 287 .3, 287 .5; community of, 52.7; confiscation of properties of, 139, 155, 284.3, 287 .4,
341.3; under death sentences, 135, 239, 280.7, 285, 286, 321, 341.2; defense of, 90.6, 216.33,
268.6, 288.6, 299.8, 331.15–16; deputization by, 248.9a–10; executions of, 3, 16, 19, 37, 59, 127,
128, 133.4, 276, 280.1–6, 286.2, 288.4, 299.8, 321.2; fortitude of, 48.4; government program
against, 287 .5–5e; imprisoned, 136, 137, 268, 278, 288, 289, 297; laws binding on, 164.5–6;
living outside i ran,
220.10, 248.6–6a, 248.9, 248.10, 248.13, 248.15–16; martyrdoms of, 1, 254, 277, 299.10, 311;
message to (1997), 248; murders of, 5, 9, 134, 179; persecution
of, 22.5, 23.8c, 48.6, 60.43, 60.45, 118.4, 129.6, 145.14,
223.3, 224.1, 248.4–5, 248.7, 248.9, 280, 284; as pilgrims, 164.4; pioneering activities, 164.5;
prayers for, 47; release of prisoners, 64.4, 90.6, 284.1, 334; sacrifices of, 38.3, 202.3, 216.39–40;
service by, 248.16; youth, 248.7–8

‘ishqábád (r ussia): b ahá’í community

of, 99.2–2a; restoration of ISA in, 64.2, 65, 90.2

islám, 10.2a, 281.4, 283.6a

island nations. See p acific i slands

israel, g overnment of, bwc

recognized by, 23

Issues Related to the Study of the Bahá’í

Faith (uhj), 296

italy, f our y ear p lan in,
221.6

italy and Switzerland, National
Spiritual Assembly of, 221.1

japan: b ahá’í studies conference in,
331.13; f our y ear p lan in, 224.7

jesus. See christ

jordan, interfaith activities in, 331.20

judaism, celebrating holy days of,

10.2a

junior youth, b ahá'í, 313.7, 331.25,
331.27, 338.5, 348.7, 357 .3

justice, 29.6, 102.13, 122.3, 183.44.

See also m ost g reat j ustice

kazakhstan, National Spiritual

Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11

kingdom of g od, establishment of

on earth, 22.12, 140.8, 145.14, 201.19, 201.21a

kitáb-i-'Ahd, The (b ahá'u'lláh, book

of the covenant), 111.54, 144.2, 145.13, 355.5

kitáb-i-Aqdas, The (b ahá'u'lláh, book

of laws), 111.54, 145.13, 201.21a;

859g e n e r a l i n D e x

applicability of laws in, 153,

168.3, 216.32, 315, 352.3; Arabic edition, 211, 216.15, 331.11; bahá'u'lláh's descriptions of,

150.2, 150.6; e nglish translation,

48.7, 64.9, 102.3, 108.11a, 129.21, 131.8, 138.8, 150, 151.4, 151.8, 281.5; references to
guardianship in, 177; revelation

of, 150.3, 176.5; Shoghi e ffendi's

descriptions of, 150.1, 150.2, 150.3; study of, 181.4

kitáb-i-íqán, The (book of

certitude), 192.2–2a

knights of b ahá'u'lláh, 131.1, 131.16;

iranian b ahá'ís among, 248.16;

roll of h onor, 90.9, 108.11d,

129.19, 131.17, 151.2; for Sakhalin island, 90.2, 129.5

knowledge, acquisition of, 215.2–3,

215.6, 215.7 . See also e ducation

korea, f our y ear p lan in, 224.7

kuwait, safety of b ahá'ís in, 106

kyrgyzstan, National Spiritual

Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11

landegg Academy (Switzerland),

331.14

laos, b ahá'í community of, 219.7

lapland b ahá'í center, 238.1

latin America: 1996 riꞖván m essage

for, 217; teaching work in, 80, 220.16

latin American y outh congress

(chile), message to, 256

latvia: message to first national

convention, 300; National Spiritual Assembly of, 299.11, 300.1

law of þuqúqu'lláh, 48.7, 216.15;

application of worldwide, 13.2, 21.11, 63, 108.12, 121.1b, 129.23, 138.7, 153.1, 181.4, 324.4, 345.4–5, 345.10, 352.1; codification of, 13.3, 21, 324.4, 345; education regarding, 62; fundamentals of, 21.6, 22.6; obedience to, 21.5, 21.8, 21.32, 345.7–8. See also þuqúqu'lláh

laws, b ahá'í, 111.54–59, 206.4,

247 .3–13; acceptance of, 109, 201.22; application of, 149.18, 164, 324; diversity honored in, 55.3a; as foundation of w orld

order of b ahá'u'lláh, 60.54,

102.18, 176.5, 201.21; importance of, 109.5, 111.77, 111.80, 131.8, 145.17–18; of inheritance, 229.2–3a, 229.4, 229.9, 307 .9; obedience to, 151.8, 181.4, 206.3–5; progressive application of, 52.7, 122.17, 307 .4; tribal practices conflicting with, 55.6; violations of, 122, 205.16–17, 247 .7–9, 250.18c, 257 .7, 355.8, 355.11. See also kitáb-i-Aqdas, The

laws, civil/criminal, violations of, 122.7 –8

leaders of thought, teaching, 85.3,

129.6

league of Nations, 356.25–29,

356.34a

learned, institution of, 251.11, 337 .14learning, promotion of, 215.6, 331.2,

348.8. See also e ducation

lesser p eace: advancement toward,

2.5, 90.20, 129.14, 200.3, 263.5, 263.8, 356.36a–37, 357 .4; establishment of, 31.2–4, 64.6, 90.14, 120.4, 151.11, 200.8, 216.38; promotion of, 18, 44.3b; timing of, 356; unity of nations and, 200.3, 356.6, 356.10–38a. See also m ost g reat p eace

liberia: media campaign in, 331.9;

National Spiritual Assembly of, 129.17, 258.5, 263.3; teaching work in, 216.7; use of the arts in, 331.10

g e n e r a l i n D e x

860Light and Fire (opera/ballet), 299.10

light of u n i t y p r o j e c t (Africa), 331.10

literacy, promotion of, 64.9, 68,

216.10, 219.4, 222.9

literature, b a h á ' í , 40.1, 216.6, 222.12

literature Subvention f u n d , 157 .8

lithuania: message to first national

convention, 301; National Spiritual Assembly of, 299.11, 301.1

local b a h á ' í communities:

development of, 212.4–7, 213.22–25, 216.25–26, 217 .5; in f o u r y e a r

plan, 213.4, 216.17–19, 234.3–6;

ISAs' relationship with, 218.10, 222.11; NSAs' relationship with, 102.7–8, 213.30

local b a h á ' í f u n d s : support for

training institutes, 231.3, 270.1a, 310.3, 310.4, 310.8

local h o u s e s o f j u s t i c e , 18.7–8, 52.3,

52.4a, 296.7

local Spiritual Assemblies (ISAs):

appealing decisions of, 257 .2–7; attendance of members, 330.7–8a; authority of, 25, 257;
Auxiliary boards' collaboration

with, 181.2, 183.15–20, 183.22–23, 212.6b, 212.6d, 213.22–25, 249.2, 331.6; by-

laws, 78.2, 102.15, 111.56;

children's education and, 348.7; committees of, 250.4; communities' relationship with, 222.11;
dissolution of, 111.19, 335.3; election of, 60.19–20, 111.13–15, 111.21, 111.22, 111.25, 111.61,
111.76, 212.6d, 213.23, 257 .2; enrollment procedures, 78.5; establishment of, 18.4, 111.55,
120.2; external affairs work, 129.6, 129.9; formation on first day of r i x v á n only, 213.26–29,
263.2, 331.12; functioning of, 151.7, 181.7, 213.22–25; incorporated, 111.10, 111.53, 111.56,
111.58, 111.75; individual's relationship with, 60.19–20, 200.7, 222.11; as local houses of
justice, 18.7–8;

maturation of, 2.5, 64.6–7, 129.12, 212.6d, 216.23–24, 224.3, 295.3, 348.2; membership on,
111.13–14, 330.4, 330.6, 330.8a–9; Nineteen day feast

and, 69.5, 69.7–8, 73.1–1b; NSAs' relationship with, 335.2; prepublication review by, 259.2a,
259.4; private business ventures and, 167; r b c s ' relationship

with, 250.6a, 250.6b, 250.12a–b, 250.17, 250.18c, 299.6, 335.2–3; role in society, 55.10, 90.19–20,
234.5–6; simultaneous service on NSA and ISA, 330.4–6;

simultaneous service on r b c

and ISA, 330.4, 330.6; Six year

plan goals, 22.2; teaching work,
 181.6, 348.17; training institutes and, 213.19, 216.28, 234, 310.5; women on, 52.7
 lotus Temple. See m ashriqu'l-
 Adhkár(s), in i ndia
 love, 60.34, 183.32–35
 macau: b ahá'í community of, 219.10;
 National Spiritual Assembly of,
 22.9, 64.5, 90.3
 macedonia: National Spiritual
 Assembly of, 298, 299.11; teaching work in, 236.4
 major p lan of g od, 64.6, 129.5,
 145.8, 183.8, 331.21, 348.21. See also m inor p lan of g od
 malaysia: b ahá'í community of, 219.4;
 National Spiritual Assembly of,
 861g e n e r a l i n D e x
 258.2, 258.3; social and economic
 development projects, 331.14
 manifestations of g od: acceptance
 of, 12.11–12, 60.5, 145.12, 355.3; appearance of, 7 .3–7; god's relationship with, 109.4,
 140, 203.5a; infallibility of, 12; interrelationships of, 140.2–3a, 140.7; nature and station of, 7 .9,
 140; obedience to, 60.5, 145.12, 203.5, 355.3. See also individual Manifestations
 mankind: distortions of, 205.14;
 duties of, 6.5, 21.14, 60.16; as first loyalty of b ahá'ís, 171.4; future of,
 194.1; g od's purpose for, 60.16,
 108.2, 263.5; g od's relationship
 with, 145.16, 296.6, 345.4; maturation of, 60.21, 60.29–30, 60.37, 205.6–7, 227 .5, 255.11a; reform
 of, 183.32a; unification of, 29.3–5b, 60.36, 60.41, 144.2, 176.3, 200.3, 201.27, 331.19, 339.3a,
 354.2. See also h uman
 resources, development of; human rights; Nations, unity of;
 oneness of mankind
 marriage: consultation in, 149.6,
 149.7, 149.9; between “eastern” and “western” bahá'ís, 164.5;
 interracial, 6.3; laws regarding, 205.13, 324.6; opposition to, 60.22; place of sex within, 149.13;
 prevention of violence within, 149.10–11, 149.13; registration of in iran, 325;

relationship of spouses in next world, 7 .10a

marshall i slands: b ahá'ís operating

schools in, 181.6; visit of president to bwc, 158

martyrs. See i ranian b ahá'ís,

martyrdoms of mashriqu'l-A dhkár(s), 296.7, 315.7;

in chile, 357 .9; in india, 22.8,

23.8h, 64.3, 129.6, 331.9; of 'ishqábád (r ussia), 99.2; in

uganda, 222.3

mass conversions, 48.3, 83.6, 90.15,

331.5. See also e ntry by troops;

expansion and consolidation

mass media. See i nternet, the; m edia

materialism, 29.5a, 205.8, 227 .2–3,

296.6, 331.24

maturity, 60.21; age of in b ahá'í

faith, 273; of mankind, 60.10,

60.21, 60.29–30, 60.37, 227 .5, 255.11a; as prerequisite for unity, 169.11b, 263.4–5; spiritual,

345.6

media: b ahá'í f aith covered in,

129.6, 129.8; h oly y ear publicity,

107 .7–9; proclamation use of, 130, 331.9, 331.18; relations with bwc, 200.8; during Three y ear

plan, 216.10–11. See also i nternet,

the; p ress, the

melanesia, f our y ear p lan in, 224.10

membership, b ahá'í: requirements

for, 32, 149.18, 255.7, 355.5; voluntary nature of, 111.22, 296.8; voting, 78; withdrawal from,

109.2, 201.22, 355. See also enrollments

men: membership of uhj restricted

to, 7 .9, 52, 187 .6, 228.4, 296.7, 337 .16; responsibility for advancement of women, 307 .3, 307

.5. See also e quality of women

and men

messengers of g od. See m anifestations

of god

middle east: dangerous conditions

in, 103, 103.2, 105.2, 108.2; documents on history of, 205.12–13, 305.13

g e n e r a l i n D e x

862millennial activities, 292.3, 342, 356.38, 357 .4

millennium f orum (uN), 331.19, 342.2–4, 342.9

millennium Summit (uN), 331.19, 342.1, 342.4, 342.7

millennium w orld p eace Summit of religious and Spiritual leaders (uN), 340, 342.5–6

minorities: oppression of, 29.6, 55.8; preference given to in tie votes, 6.3–4; rights of, 201.22–25; teaching work among, 221.6. See also i ndigenous believers; indigenous peoples

minor p lan of g od, 263.5–7 . See also major p lan of g od

mírzá m ihdi (The p urest b ranch), monument to, 36.2, 176.6

mírzá m uĤammad-‘Alí, 177 .4; descendants of, 255.5a–6

mírzá y aĤyá, descendants of, 255.5a–6

moderation, 60.13, 60.17, 60.24, 60.56, 163.2, 183.42

moldova, National Spiritual Assembly of, 214.1b, 216.34. See also ukraine, b elarus and m oldova, regional Spiritual Assembly of; ukraine and m oldova, r egional Spiritual Assembly of

mongolia: b ahá‘í community of, 219.8; establishment of ISAs in, 98.1; first native believer in, 90.3; National Spiritual Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11; study circles in, 331.3

morality: b ahá'í standard of, 56.3–5a;

decline of, 56.2, 56.5, 149.5, 151.8, 183.3, 183.27, 263.9; sexual, 149.13, 205.13, 206.5. See also i mmorality

moscow (r ussia), 99moses, 140.5c, 140.6a

most e xalted leaf. See Navváb (ásíyíh

khánum, m ost e xalted leaf)

most g reat covenant, 356.13a. See

also covenant of b ahá'u'lláh

most g reat j ustice, 257 .3. See also

justice

most g reat Name. See g reatest Name

most g reat p eace: b ahá'u'lláh

as author of, 131.4, 257 .3; establishment of, 18.11a, 18.12, 31.3a–4, 48.6, 216.39, 331.22, 356.8, 356.21a; goal of, 60.31, 201.13, 263.6; prerequisites for, 356.9, 356.19a; wwí signalizes dawn of, 356.5. See also lesser peace

most holy book. See kitáb-i-Aqdas, The

mount carmel, 176.11. See also Tablet

of carmel

mount carmel p rojects:

commencement of, 64.6–7, 66, 120.4, 151.11; completion of, 90.14, 216.35, 216.38, 356.23–23b, 357 .11; dedicatory events, 299.11; development of, 23.8j, 23.9, 36; f our y ear p lan goals,

216.32, 348.2; o ffice of p roject

manager, 64.10; progress reports,

83, 90.7, 105.2, 113, 114, 129.13, 148, 160, 193, 198, 200.8–9, 216.2, 249.5, 263.3, 299.3, 331.7; significance of, 90.20, 176, 181.3. See also Arc p rojects f und; and

individual buildings

muḩammad, 140.2, 140.5c, 163.3,

201.2a; infallibility of, 12.6a. See also i slám; q ur'án

muslims: conflicts with h indus,

202.1, 202.4; teaching b ahá'í

faith to, 222.12. See also i slam

myanmar, b ahá'í community of,

219.5

86g e n e r a l i n D e x

National b ahá'í communities, 22.7,

28.1–2, 48.5

National b ahá'í funds: support for

training institutes, 231.3, 270.1a,

310.3, 310.4, 310.8

National houses of justice, 18.7–8,

52.3, 52.4a, 201.22

Nationalism, 129.14, 356.24a,

356.26a

National Spiritual Assemblies (NSAs):

Auxiliary boards' collaboration with, 213.10; bic 's collaboration

with, 8.4–8.6, 61.1, 253; burdens of, 200.5; committees of, 183.19, 183.25, 250.4; continental boards

of counselors' collaboration with, 23.8e, 103.2–3, 151.11, 157 .4–5, 183.12–25, 212.6b, 213.6–7, 213.24, 249.2, 313.6, 331.6; continental pioneering

committees and, 88.3–4, 88.6–8, 88.10, 89.5, 343.4; d eclaration

of T rust and b y-laws, 102.15,

111.56; d eputies of þuqúqu'lláh

and, 62.2; elections of, 102.5a, 102.8, 185.4–4a, 232.5, 337 .15; enrollment procedures, 78.5; executive committees, 33;

external affairs work, 44.7–8, 48.4, 79, 90.19–20, 120.3, 129.6, 129.9, 331.17; formation of, 102.4, 121.1a, 121.3, 123, 129.17, 173, 181.11, 191, 200.10, 214, 216.5, 216.34, 248.2, 258, 263.3, 299.11, 331.12; formulation of goals for Six y ear p lan, 22.2,

23.8e, 71.1; f our y ear p lan and,

234.3; functions of, 102.8, 151.7, 183.45, 196.2, 196.4, 232.5; handling violations of b ahá'í

laws, 122.4–5, 122.19, 122.21; incorporation of, 111.10, 111.56, 233; interassembly projects, 22.9, 27 .2, 48.5, 71.1, 138.6, 333; local communities' relationship with, 102.7–8, 213.30; ISAs' relationship with, 111.15, 111.17, 111.19, 111.21, 111.64, 111.76, 335.2; maturation of, 2.5, 64.6–7, 129.12, 138.7, 216.23–24, 263.3, 265.2, 348.2; membership on, 102.5–6, 102.12, 183.30, 232.5; as National houses of justice,

18.7–8; officers' conduct, 102.12, 183.43; pioneer placement by, 89.3, 243.2–4; prepublication review by, 118.2, 118.7, 259.2a, 259.4–5, 305.7; private business ventures and, 167, 245; promotion of human rights, 29.8, 245; rbcs'

relationship with, 250.2, 250.6a, 250.6d, 250.6e, 250.7, 250.14–25, 299.6, 335.2; simultaneous service on NSA and ISA, 330.4–6; simultaneous service on NSA and rbc, 250.11d; social and economic development work, 129.10; teaching work, 103.3, 181.6, 212.8; training institutes and, 213.18, 213.21, 216.28, 231.1, 310.5; unity within, 183.29–30; women on, 52.7 . See also conventions, national; and individual National Spiritual Assemblies by country

National Teaching committees, rbcs

and, 250.28–31

Nations, unity of: attainment of,

356.2–3, 356.7, 356.28; growing consciousness of, 60.10, 356.33–38a; lesser peace and, 200.3,

356.6, 356.10–38a; revelation

of bahá'u'lláh, 108.13, 227.5a; in

trade and finance, 263.8, 331.21, 356.36a. See also mankind,

unification of

general index

86Native American Indian bahá'í

institute, 25.2

Native communities. See indigenous

peoples

Nature. See conservation;

environment, the

Navváb (ásíyih khánúm, most

exalted leaf), 7.9; monument of,

36.2, 176.6

Nepal, bahá'í community of, 218.6

Network on conservation and

religion, 42, 48.5, 58, 129.9. See

also world wide fund for Nature

(wwf)

New South Wales (Australia), bahá'í

curriculum in schools, 64.3

New world order. See world order of

bahá'u'lláh

New year (gregorian), celebration of,

10.2b

New York city, as city of the

covenant, 90.10, 108.11e, 129.20,

144.3, 144.8, 145.20

New Zealand, four year plan in, 224.11

Niger, National Spiritual Assembly of,

123.3, 129.18

Nigeria: National Spiritual Assembly

of, 214.1a; women's conference in, 116

Nineteen day feast, 60.33, 69, 70,

73, 213.23, 348.17; new believers at, 78.4; use of arts at, 222.13

Nine year plan (1964–73), 213.14

Nongovernmental organizations. See

united Nations, nongovernmental

organizations

Non-profit organizations, 167 .2–3North America: external affairs work

in, 48.5; rixvân message for

1996, 220. See also American bahá'í community; canada;

united States, National Spiritual

Assembly ofNortheastern Asia: bahá'í community

of, 224.2–3; four year plan in,

224.7

obligatory prayer: compilation on,

336; laws regarding, 315.3–5, 324.3, 324.6, 352.1

office for the Advancement of

women (bic), 147, 216.9, 307 .2,

307 .5, 307 .8

office of puqúqu'lláh, establishment

of, 121.1b

office of public information (bic),

8.3, 76.4, 216.33; NSAs' collaboration with, 8.4, 8.6, 253

office of Social and economic

development (bwc), 76.4,

216.33, 299.7, 331.14

office of the environment (bic),

76.4, 90.5, 129.9

old world order, breakdown of,

102.18, 108.2, 145.6, 145.16, 149.5. See also integration and

disintegration, processes of; Social problems; Society, degeneration of

oneness of mankind: b ahá'í principle
 of, 6.2, 6.5, 46.4, 55.7, 99.4, 145.13; covenant of b ahá'u'lláh
 and, 46.2, 60.6, 109.4–5, 144.3; importance of, 149.2, 183.32, 224.4; realization of, 48.6, 202.6c,
 356.19a. See also mankind, unification of
 open letter p roject (Albania), 181.6
 opposition: external, 18.7, 38.4,
 60.44–46, 118.4, 216.40, 218.6; internal, 272.4, 296. See also covenant-breakers; i ranian
 bahá'ís, persecution of
 order and chaos, processes of. See
 integration and disintegration,
 processes of
 organizations of civil society, 331.19
 865g e n e r a l i n D e x
 pacific i slands: b ahá'í communities
 in, 4.3, 158.1; four year plan in,
 224.1–12; riṣván message for
 1996, 224; teaching work in, 216.7 ,
 221.6; uN office in, 90.5; visit by
 bic representative, 279, 299.9. See
 also individual island nations
 pacific w omen's conference, message
 to, 110
 pakistan, f our y ear p lan in, 223.7
 panama, social and economic
 development projects, 331.14
 papua New g uinea: b ahá'í studies
 conference in, 331.13; f our y ear
 plan in, 224.10; visit of prime
 minister to bwc, 158
 parents: dealing with homosexuality,
 124; loss of rights as, 149.12, 149.17; responsibilities of, 141.3b, 141.4, 141.8, 141.10, 149.17,
 273.1, 273.3, 331.28
 parliament of the w orld's r eligions,
 The (cape Town), 331.20

Payam-e-Doost (radio program),

331.18, 353

peace: b ahá'í community as example

of, 14.3; commemorative world events for, 340; education for, 85, 90.5, 108.9; establishment of, 8.6, 216.36–39, 331.21; as goal of b ahá'í f aith, 183.5,

342.10; movement toward, 31, 48.2, 216.33, 263.4–5, 279.2–3, 342.2; prerequisites for, 6.2, 110.1, 151.4, 169.11a, 194.1; prospects for, 342.2, 342.5. See also convocation of world leaders; lesser p eace; m ost g reat p eace

peace Statement. See Promise of World

Peace, The

people of capacity, teaching, 85.3,

90.18, 151.9, 181.5; compilation on, 94philippine i slands, f our y ear p lan in,

224.8

pilgrimages/pilgrims, 21.20, 164.4;

cancelation of, 100.1; increase in number of, 216.32, 299.4, 331.7, 357 .10; reception center, 299.4, 331.7, 357 .5

pioneers: to Africa, 220.9, 331.8;

continental boards of counselors'

relationship to, 243; to eastern

bloc countries, 24, 71.1, 71.8, 84.3;

european, 221.3, 221.6; facilitating,

88.2–10; four year plan, 217 .4,

218.14, 235.2–3, 331.8; iranian

bahá'í, 164.5; iTc responsibilities

for, 272.6, 272.7f; murders of in South Africa, 179; short-term, 22.9, 71.4–7 , 88.8, 89.5; Six year

plan, 22.9, 24, 48.7 , 71, 158; Three

year plan, 157 .9, 159, 161, 181.10,

190.1, 216.5, 235.1, 243.2, 343.2, 343.5–6; youth as, 129.11. See also

continental pioneer committees;

homefront pioneers; international

deputization fund; T raveling

teachers

pluralism, religious, 202.4

poland: establishment of ISAs in,

98.1; National Spiritual Assembly of, 121.1a, 129.18, 269.3

politics, partisan, b ahá'ís'

noninvolvement in, 35.5, 44.1, 44.5, 46.2–3, 79.2, 96.8; b ahá'í

administration as alternative to, 29.6, 55.8, 96.10–12, 109.2, 201.18–19, 207 .7–7c, 224.4;
promoting peace through, 18, 31.2. See also Apartheid

portugal, bahá'í courses in schools, 299.9

poverty, elimination of extremes of

wealth and, 21.5, 21.9, 21.15, 345.4

prayer, 21.14, 183.10, 246.2. See also

obligatory prayer

g e n e r a l i n D e x

866prayer for the d ead, recitation of, 26,

168

pregnancy, as result of rape, 149.12,

149.17

prepublication review, 60.42–47,

72, 102.16–18, 118, 119, 259; of

historical documents, 305.9–18,

305.15; of translations, 304.2–5, 305.3, 305.7

press, the, 60.37–41. See also m edia

priesthood, abolition of, 215.4, 225.4,

337 .6

promised d ay of g od, 145.19

Promise of World Peace, The:

distribution of, 21.6, 22.3, 23.8d, 23.8f, 31.5, 48.8, 129.6; presentation to leaders, 18.6, 48.8;
responses to, 4.1, 85.1–2

Promoting Entry by Troops, 172, 181.9property, legal claims to, 29.7 . See also

iranian b ahá'ís, confiscation of

properties of

prophetic e ra, 22.10

prophets, 7 .4–5, 7 .8, 229.18. See also

manifestations of g od

Prosperity of Humankind, The, 194,

216.13

provincial b ahá'í councils, 250.7 .

See also r egional b ahá'í councils

(rbcs)

publishing T rust(s), b ahá'í, 40.1

qur'án, 7 .5, 281.4

racism, 129.14radio stations, b ahá'í, 22.6, 23.8i,

331.14, 331.18, 353

rape, 149.12–13, 149.17reflection meetings, 348.18

regional b ahá'í councils (rbcs),

250; appointed, 250.13–13b; Auxiliary boards' relationship with, 344.4; characteristics of,

250.5–6e, 250.11–13; continental boards of counselors' relationship

with, 299.6, 344.4; elected, 250.12–12g; evolution of, 348.2; formation of, 250.9–10, 326, 331.6; functions of, 250.14–27a, 335; funding, 250.22–24; legal

status, 250.26; membership on,

250.12e, 330; national committees and, 250.28–32; simultaneous service on rbc and ISA, 330.4, 330.6; Spiritual Assemblies' relationship with, 299.6; training institutes and, 250.30, 299.6

regional Teaching and Administrative

committees, 250.1, 250.7

religion(s), 201.3; degraded by

material wealth, 21.15; disunity of, 145.9–10, 202.1, 202.4; establishment of, 7 .4, 7 .6a; fundamentalist, 26.9, 129.14, 202.4, 263.9; interfaith activities, 216.14, 331.20; multiplication of, 263.9; non-b ahá'í, 201.3;

oneness of, 109.5; opposition to, 60.22; science in agreement with, 169.11b, 203.6; state, 201.17a, 201.21a–22; truths of, 109.4, 205.6; unity of, 109.5, 202.4–5. See also Network on conservation and r eligion; Separation of

church and state; State r eligion,

bahá'í f aith as; Theocracy, b ahá'í;

and specific religions

revelation of b ahá'u'lláh, 201.9–10;

Administrative o rder and, 250.3,

337 .3; influences of, 60.53, 129.15, 145.7, 183.5, 216.35, 356.19a; magnitude of, 55.2, 60.55, 131.4, 140.7, 146.2; power of, 90.1, 108.4, 129.2, 149.18, 227 .8; purpose of, 22.10, 60.4, 60.10, 131.7–8, 131.13, 216.39, 227 .5a, 355.6; study of, 157 .7,

169.2–4, 187, 215.3, 296.1. See

867g e n e r a l i n D e x

also b ahá'í f aith; kitáb-i-'Ahd,

The; kitáb-i-Aqdas, The; w orld
 order of b ahá'u'lláh
 revelation of g od, 7 .6a, 12.6a, 296.10
 riḥvân, formation of ISAs on f irst
 day of only, 213.26–29, 263.2,
 331.12
 riḥvân m essages: for 1987, 22; for
 1988, 48; for 1989, 64; for 1990,
 90; for 1991, 108; for 1992, 129; for 1993, 151; for 1994, 181; for 1995, 200; for 1996, 216; for 1996
 (Africa), 222; for 1996 (Australia and p acific i slands), 224; for
 1996 (e urope), 221; for 1996
 (india and neighboring countries),
 218; for 1996 (latin America
 and caribbean), 217; for 1996 (North America), 220; for 1996 (Southeast Asia), 219; for 1996
 (western and central Asia), 223;
 for 1997, 249; for 1998, 263; for 1999, 299; for 2001, 357
 right of g od. See þuqúqu'lláh
 rights: within families, 149.3–3a; of
 indigenous peoples, 46, 55.7–9; individual, 60, 102.15, 201.22–25; legal claims to, 29.7 . See
 also Administrative rights, deprivation of; e quality of women and men;
 human rights
 rise and fall, processes of. See
 integration and disintegration,
 processes of
 romania: establishment of ISAs in,
 98.1; government recognition of bahá'í community, 108.5;
 National Spiritual Assembly of, 104.1, 105.1, 108.5, 108.6, 269.3
 romany peoples, teaching work
 among, 221.6
 rúŷíyyih khánum, Amatu'l-b ahá
 (hand of the cause of g od):
 'Abdu'llah páshá h ouse furnished by, 92.1; in b razil, 233.1, 233.4,
 249.4; bwc activities, 91.1, 186.3, 216.15; at counselors' meetings, 53.2, 212.2, 275.2;
 environmental activities, 42.1, 58.2, 188.1, 216.14; funeral service for, 317, 318; meetings with
 counselors, 53.2; at NSA inaugural conventions, 90.3, 108.6, 129.18, 200.10, 216.34; passing of,

316, 331.30; r oll of
 honor deposited by, 131.17; in
 russia, 181.10–11; at second
 world congress, 144.5
 russia: Amatu'l-b ahá rú'íyyih
 khánúm in, 181.10–11; b ahá'í
 community of, 221.6; b ahá'u'lláh's
 relations with, 99.2; National Spiritual Assembly of, 191.2, 221.3; teaching work in, 221.6
 russia, g eorgia and Armenia,
 regional Spiritual Assembly of,
 123.2, 191.2
 rwanda, National Spiritual Assembly
 of, 216.34, 249.7
 ryukyu i slands, teaching work in,
 224.7
 Sabah, National Spiritual Assembly of,
 258.2, 263.3, 299.2
 Sacred w ritings. See b ahá'í Scriptures
 Sakhalin i sland, knight of b ahá'u'lláh
 for, 90.2, 129.5
 Sami people, teaching work among,
 221.6, 238.1
 Sanctity and Nature of Bahá'í Elections,
 The, 81
 São Tomé and p ríncipe, National
 Spiritual Assembly of, 214.1a, 216.34
 Sarawak, National Spiritual Assembly
 of, 258.3, 263.3, 299.2
 Schism, covenant as guarantee
 against, 52.2, 60.6, 145.14
 g e n e r a l i n D e x
 868Scholars/scholarship, b ahá'í, 36.4c,
 169, 215, 331.13; compilation on,

195; promotion of, 18.5, 251.10, 272.4, 357 .10. See also b ahá'í
 f aith, study of; b ahá'í Scriptures,
 study of; h istorical documents;
 T ranslations of b ahá'í Scriptures
 Science: advances in, 263.4; religion in
 agreement with, 169.11b, 203.6
 Scriptures. See b ahá'í Scriptures; b ible;
 qur'án
 Seat of u niversal h ouse of j ustice,
 23.9, 36.2, 36.6, 176.8
 Secularism, 183.27–28, 202.4Self, the. See i ndividual, the
 Self-expression. See f reedom(s), of
 expression
 Separation of church and state, 201,
 296.7
 Service, commitment to, 183.33–34.
 See also y outh year of service
 Seven y ear p lan (1937–44), fiftieth
 anniversary of, 22.11
 Seven y ear p lan (1979–86), 22.12,
 23.8c, 36.2
 Sex, proper use of, 149.13, 205.13Sexual abuse, prevention of, 149.1,
 149.5–6
 Seychelles, visit to bwc by president
 of, 186
 Shoghi e ffendi: appointment as
 guardian, 144.5, 177 .3, 255.8–8a;
 as authorized interpreter, 17 .1–2, 52.2, 52.6, 111.54, 118.3–3a, 192.4–5, 255.10a, 283.3;
 Auxiliary boards instituted by, 350.4; completion of i nternational
 Archives b uilding, 176.7;
 completion of Shrine of the báb, 16.6, 36.2, 91.2, 176.7; covenant-breakers in family of,
 255.4–8; design of Arc, 36.2, 36.4a; global vision of, 129.16;
 involvement with Bahá'í World series, 170.3; lack of successor

to, 255.1–10; passing of, 144.5; purchase of property near grave of, 50; relations with i srael, 23.3;

translation of b ahá'í Scriptures

by, 192.2–2a, 192.4–5; writings

on r evelation of b ahá'u'lláh,

201.9–10

Shrine of the báb, 36.2, 91.2, 176.7,

331.9. See also Terraces of the

Shrine of the báb

Siberia, 181.6, 220.11Sicily, National Spiritual Assembly of,

191.1, 200.10

Sierra leone, teaching work in, 216.7Singapore, b ahá'í community of, 219.9

Six y ear p lan (1986–92):

accomplishments of, 64.2–7, 108.5–11, 129.4–13, 170.2; goals of, 13.1, 21.1, 22.1–2, 27, 40.1, 62.1, 64.8–13, 90.14, 105.1, 138.2–3, 138.5–6, 150.3, 213.7; themes of, 22.10, 45.3. See also pioneers, Six y ear p lan; T wo y ear

plan for eastern e urope and Asia

Slovakia, National Spiritual Assembly

of, 258.4, 263.3, 269, 299.2. See also c zech and Slovak r epublics,

regional Spiritual Assembly of

Slovenia and c roatia, r egional

Spiritual Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11

Social and economic development

projects, 14.3, 85, 295.4; in cambodia, 219.7; f our y ear p lan

activities, 216.33, 222.13, 331.6, 331.14; funding for, 120.2; in india, 218.13; intensive programs

of growth and, 348.17; non-profit organizations for, 167 .2–3; Six y ear

plan activities, 22.6; statement on,

194; Three y ear p lan activities,

216.4, 216.9–10; training institutes

and, 299.7, 348.2; women's

869g e n e r a l i n D e x

involvement in, 116.1, 129.10;

youth's involvement in, 129.11. See also o ffice of Social and e conomic

development; w orld Summit for

Social development

Social and economic development

unit (bic), 8.3

Social problems, 151.5, 200.1–3,

200.11, 299.12, 356.35a, 356.36a; bahá'í solutions to, 29.5–5b, 46.2,

55.8, 76.2, 90.19, 96, 99.7, 109.2, 129.6, 149.19–19a, 176.3, 295.2–3. See also economic problems;

integration and disintegration,

processes of; morality, decline of

Society: degeneration of, 60.22,

183.3–10, 183.44, 205.8, 205.17, 216.37–41, 227.2–4, 299.12; evolution of, 201.11; individual's relation to, 60.49–52; reform of, 183.32–32a, 227.5–7. See also integration and disintegration,

processes of; old world order,

breakdown of

Sodomy, 205.3, 205.3a Sons, first-born, 229.18–22 Soul, the, 68.2, 129.24, 162.7, 205.6;

reality of, 7.7, 99.6, 140.2, 205.6

Soul mates, 7.10–10a South Africa: bahá'í community in,

6.4–6.5, 222.3, 299.9; murders of pioneers in, 179; National Spiritual Assembly of, 108.8, 191.3, 200.10; statement on apartheid, 6

Southeast Asia: four year plan in,

224.11; rixvân message for 1996,

219; youth in, 208, 346

Soviet union: 'Alí-Akbar furútan in,

90.3; bahá'í faith in, 23.8h, 61.1,

65.1, 129.5; collapse of, 129.5, 129.11, 129.14; establishment of ISAs in, 90.2, 98.1, 108.5; National Spiritual Assembly of, 104.1, 105.1, 108.5, 108.6; pioneer goals, 24; youth activities in, 129.11. See also Russia; Two year

plan for eastern Europe and Asia

Speech, characteristics of, 60.37. See

also Freedom(s), of expression

Spiritual Assemblies: appealing

decisions of, 102.15; Auxiliary boards' relationship with, 344.4; consultation on, 60.28–29, 60.32–36; continental boards of counselors' relationship with, 344.4; decisions about membership status, 355.7–8; duties of, 60.32; external affairs work, 96.8; fostering proper functioning of, 151.9–10, 200.5, 212.5, 222.11; fostering unity in the community, 183.32–35, 337.12–12a; handling violations of bahá'í laws, 122, 205.16–17;

incorporated, 111.65–67; individuals' relationship with, 25.3, 183.35–48, 206.2–4; maturation of, 102.13, 201.17a, 216.24; membership on, 67 .3–7, 78.2; obedience to, 60.32, 60.33, 67 .3, 225.7; problems involving members of, 102.14; responsibilities of, 313.7, 337 .7–7a; South African, 6.4; spouses serving on, 102.13; training, 6.5. See also local Spiritual Assemblies; National Spiritual Assemblies

Spiritual axis, 213.11, 224.2, 242Spiritual growth, 225.2, 225.6, 227 .5,

263.8–9. See also Transformation, spiritual

Sri Lanka, Bahá'í community of, 218.7

State Bahá'í councils, 250.1, 250.7 .

See also regional Bahá'í councils

State religion, Bahá'í faith as, 18.8a,

201.17a, 201.21a–22. See also Separation of church and state

general index

870Study circles, 331.3, 348.5,

348.17

Suffering, Bahá'í attitude toward,

122.18, 129.15, 176.2, 181.8,

187 .4, 190.2, 199.2, 223.1, 227 .7

Summit on the Alliance between

religion and conservation

(England), 216.14

Switzerland, social and economic

development in, 331.14. See also Italy and Switzerland, National

Spiritual Assembly of

Synopsis and codification of the laws

of the Kitáb-i-Aqdas, 150.3

Systematization, 263.10–12, 331.5,

348.1, 357 .7; for human resource development, 313.3; in teaching, 313.6–7, 348.8, 348.11–19; training institutes and, 328, 331.2–4

System of Bahá'u'lláh, 108.2, 145.19,

250.3. See also Administrative order, Bahá'í; World order of

Bahá'u'lláh

Tablet of Carmel (Bahá'u'lláh), 36.1,

129.13, 176.5–7

Tablets of the Divine Plan ('Abdu'l-

bahá), 18.3, 176.5, 183.10,
 183.11, 220.1, 220.4, 220.8, 220.13, 220.16–17, 248.2
 Tablet to b ahá'ís of New y ork city
 ('Abdu'l-b ahá), 144.8
 Taiwan, b ahá'í community of, 219.10
 Tajikistan: martyrdom of i ranian
 bahá'í in, 311; National Spiritual
 Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11
 Task f orce of literacy (uNeSco),
 90.5
 Teaching: acceleration of, 108.10,
 190.2, 200.3–4, 213.4, 213.33; achievements in, 64.1, 151.3, 221.8, 263.12; confidence in,
 172.4, 222.12, 263.2; constancy in, 22.9, 64.11, 64.13, 212.5;
 expansion of, 48.3, 64.9, 90.2, 151.6, 181.2, 216.38, 221.9, 331.3; funds for, 120.5; importance of,
 36.6, 48.8–11, 54.5, 57 .1, 218.14; by individual believers, 89.1, 90.12, 200.11–12, 212.5–6,
 216.20, 220.8, 225, 310.4, 310.5, 313.3, 348.8–10; institutions' role in, 103.3, 141.7, 225.7;
 objectives of, 90.14, 90.16; passion for, 217 .8; sacred duty of, 141.2, 200.7, 225.1–6a, 248.9,
 263.14–15, 310.4, 310.5, 348.10; systematization of, 313.6–7, 348.8, 348.11–19; Three y ear p lan
 activities, 216.5; in u.S., 183.1–11;
 wisdom in, 162; by youth, 129.11, 141.2, 200.4, 209.3. See also b ahá'í
 faith, proclamation of; e xpansion
 and consolidation; m ass
 conversions; p eople of capacity,
 teaching
 Teaching projects, Three y ear p lan,
 213.4, 216.5. See also i ntensive
 programs of growth
 Technology, 129.14, 263.4Temples. See m ashriqu'l-A dhkár(s)
 Ten y ear w orld c rusade, 129.19,
 144.5–6, 218.3, 221.1, 222.3, 248.16. See also knights of bahá'u'lláh
 Terraces of the Shrine of the báb:
 commencement of work on, 91, 92.2, 129.13; completion of, 48.7, 90.14, 151.11, 198; design for,
 23.9, 36.4a, 64.2; opening of, 357 .11; progress reports, 98.2, 108.11b, 113.1–2, 114.2, 114.5–6,
 160.1, 193.2, 200.9, 216.2, 249.5, 299.3; property acquisitions for, 244; significance of, 36.6,
 176.8–9

Testament, writing of, 229.2, 229.6–7a

871general index

Tests, 183.10, 216.39, 216.41, 356.21a,

356.22a; for Iranian bahá'ís,

248.7–8, 248.17

Thailand, bahá'í community of, 219.6

Theocracy, bahá'í, 201.2–2a, 337.6–7

Three year plan (1993–96):

accomplishments of, 181.1–11,

200.4–10, 216.1–15, 240.3, 248.2; in Bangladesh, 218.5; goals of,

121.1c, 138, 151.5–13, 157.4, 190, 200.6, 213.7; in U.S., 183.18. See also pioneers, Three year plan

Training, 151.9, 213.16, 222.12, 265.4,

348.8

Training institutes, 213.15–21,

216.27–30, 216.38, 217.4, 263.2, 266, 299.5–7; Auxiliary boards' involvement in, 212.6c, 213.18, 213.19, 216.28, 270.5, 310.6–7, 310.8; continental boards of counselors' involvement in, 212.6c, 213.18, 216.27, 310.4, 310.6, 331.4; deputizing teachers for, 231.3–4, 270, 310; entry by troops through, 220.2–3, 236.2, 331.3, 348.5; establishment of, 249.3, 263.11, 331.6; expansion and consolidation through, 223.7, 299.6; in five year plan, 348.4–7;

in four year plan, 218.9–10,

221.8, 224.3, 234.4, 265.4, 308.1, 313.2, 357.3; funding, 213.21, 231, 310; importance of, 219.3, 222.14; intensive programs of growth and, 348.15; ISAs and, 213.19, 216.28, 234, 310.5; rbc's and, 250.30, 299.6; social and economic development projects through, 299.7, 348.2; Spiritual Assemblies' involvement in, 216.28; training of children's class teachers, 216.6, 313.7, 331.25, 348.7, 357.3–4; Twelve month

plan goals, 313.6, 331.22; use of radio, 331.14; youth involvement in, 256.3, 338.2, 347.2

“Training institutes and Systematic growth” (ITC), 328

Transformation: collective, 331.3;

individual, 138.9, 183.32a, 331.3; moral, 56.5–5a, 339.5; personal, 48.10, 68.1, 90.12; as purpose of bahá'í faith, 64.11; spiritual,

29.5b, 96.4, 96.5a, 96.11, 149.18, 151.8, 221.8

Transkei. See South Africa, National

Spiritual Assembly of

Translations of bahá'í Scriptures,

192, 331.7; authorized, 304.2, 305.7; into English, 192.2–3,

281.5–6, 299.4, 304, 305, 357 .10; by individuals, 192.3, 302.6–7, 304.3–5, 305.2–3, 305.7; prepublication review, 304.2–5, 305.3, 305.7; provisional, 304.3–5, 305.3, 305.7, 305.17; by Shoghi effendi, 192.2–2a, 192.4–5. See

also under kitáb-i-Aqdas, The

T raveling teachers: continental boards

of counselors' relationship to, 243; in eastern b loc countries,

84.3; in e urope, 221.6; f our y ear

plan, 217 .4, 218.14, 235.2–3,

331.8; iT c responsibilities for,

272.6, 272.7f; Six y ear p lan, 48.7,

71.2–5; Three y ear p lan, 159, 161,

181.10, 190.1, 216.5, 235.1, 343.2, 343.5–6; youth as, 129.11. See also continental p ioneer committees

T rustee of þuqúqu'lláh, 13.2, 21.12,

21.17–32, 121.1b, 345.11

T rustees of the continental f und,

54.4

T rustworthiness, compilation on, 14T ruth, 109.3–4, 122.9–9a, 169.8,

263.8, 302.8. See also candor; independent investigation of

truth

g e n e r a l i n D e x

872T ubingen (germany), local Spiritual

Assembly of: constitutional appeal

made by, 111.11–12, 111.36, 111.50; incorporation of, 111.62–71

T unisia, b ahá'í community in, 222.3

T urkey: b ahá'í community in, 221.1;

continental board of counselors, 2.2; earthquake in, 309

T urkmenistan, National Spiritual

Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11

“T urning p oint for All Nations” (bic),

216.13

T uvalu, b ahá'í f aith in, 108.9

T welve m onth p lan (2000–2001),

313.5–8, 331.22–30, 338.5, 348.6, 357 .3–6

Twentieth century, 299.12, 356.24–

32; ‘Abdu’l-bahá’s praise of,

210.1, 216.35, 263.16, 292.1; commemorating end of, 292, 331.9, 331.22; uhj statements on, 354, 357.3; unity of nations established during, 356.7, 356.14–17a

Twain processes. See integration and
disintegration, processes of

Two year plan for eastern Europe and
Asia (1990–92), 84, 90.2, 98.1, 121.1a, 129.5

Uganda, MASHRIQU’L-A DHKÁR in, 222.3

Ukraine: National Spiritual Assembly
of, 214.1c, 269.3; teaching work in, 221.6

Ukraine, Belarus and Moldova,
regional Spiritual Assembly of,
123.1a, 129.18

Ukraine and Moldova, regional
Spiritual Assembly of, 191.2, 214.1b–c
‘Ulamá, abolition of, 215.4

United Kingdom: Bahá’í publishing

Trust, 40.1; interfaith activities in, 331.20; National Spiritual Assembly of, 221.1
United Nations (UN), 356.29–31a,

356.34a–36a; Bahá’í association

with, 8.2, 18.5, 61.1, 64.3, 147.2, 263.8; fiftieth Anniversary,

216.13, 216.37, 356.35a; international literacy year (1990),

68.6; millennial activities, 292.3, 342, 356.38; nongovernmental organizations, 48.4, 64.4, 68.5,
120.3, 129.8, 129.10, 147.2, 194.1, 216.11, 216.33, 357.4; resolutions on Bahá’ís in Iran, 268.6,
288.6,

299.8. See also Bahá’í international

community; and individual UN agencies

United Nations children’s fund, bic’s

consultative status with, 8.2

United Nations conference on

environment and development

(Rio de Janeiro), 151.3

United Nations development fund

for w omen (uNifem), 129.10,
 331.17; bic 's collaboration with,
 147 .2
 united Nations e ducational, Scientific
 and c ultural o rganization
 (uNeSco), 216.14
 united Nations o ffice (bic), 76.4,
 216.33, 253
 u.S. h ouse of r epresentatives, efforts
 for b ahá'ís in i ran, 90.6
 united States, National Spiritual
 Assembly of: bic 's collaboration
 with, 8.6; continental boards of counselors and, 183.12–25; functioning of, 183.26–48;
 genocide convention and, 44.7;
 membership on, 102.6; teaching work, 183.1–11; uhj response to concerns of, 183. See also
 American b ahá'í community
 united States and canada, National
 Spiritual Assembly of: d eclaration
 of T rust and b y-laws, 111.56
 87g e n e r a l i n D e x
 unity: in diversity, 55.4, 90.16, 99.4–4a;
 divine, 203.5; economic, 356.31a;
 as foundation of peace, 169.11a,
 194.1; movement toward, 263.4–5; political, 18.12, 200.3, 356.6, 356.19b. See also bahá'í
 community,
 unity of; bahá'í faith, unity of;
 disunity; Nations, unity of
 unity college (ethiopia), 299.7 , 331.14
 universal court of Arbitration,
 201.16a, 283.4–4a
 universal h ouse of j ustice (uhj):
 appealing decisions to, 122.19; authority of, 111.10, 251, 255.10a; constitution of,
 102.15; continental boards of
 counselors appointed by, 183.15;

elections, 20, 49, 52.3–3b, 54.1, 152, 264, 327, 337 .15; elucidations of bahá'í Scriptures
by, 192.5–7, 201.16a, 251.5, 283.2–6a; establishment of world order, 18.11a, 255.10a;
functions of, 177 .5, 201.11b, 302.2; infallibility of, 192.7, 228.2a–3; iTc's consultations
with, 157, 181.2; legislation by, 192.6, 201.13a, 283.3–3a, 283.5, 283.8a; membership restricted
to men, 7 .9, 52, 187 .6, 228.4, 296.7, 337 .16; promotion of lesser peace, 44.3b; relations
with government(s), 23.4a, 23.4b, 44.3–4; role of, 228, 283; supervision of lSAs, 111.64;
world leaders consulting with, 4.1, 23.8f, 44.3–4. See also bahá'í
world center (bwc); Seat of
universal house of justice
universidad Núr (bolivia), 197, 331.14
uSSr. See eastern b loc countries;
russia; Soviet u nion
uzbekistan, National Spiritual
Assembly of, 173.2, 181.11victory. See c risis and victory
vietnam: b ahá'í community of, 219.7;
collis f eatherstone's visit to, 90.3
violence, 149, 183.3
virtues, 145.7, 339.3a
voices of b ahá choir, 299.10
voting. See Administrative rights,
deprivation of; conventions, bahá'í; e lections, b ahá'í
wealth, elimination of extremes of
poverty and, 21.5, 21.9, 21.15, 345.4
west, the: laws binding in, 164;
seventy-fifth anniversary of 'Abdu'l-b ahá's visit to, 22.11
western Asia: f our y ear p lan in,
223.4–9; riāván m essage for
1996, 223
west leeward i slands, National
Spiritual Assembly of, 105.1, 108.5, 108.6
“who is w riting the f uture?” (bic),
292.2, 292.5, 331.18
will and Testament of 'Abdu'l-b ahá,

111.54, 144.5, 176.5, 183.15, 283.3–3a, 355.5; Shoghi Effendi's
 appointment as guardian, 144.5,
 177.3, 255.8–8a
 will of God, 60.5, 60.15, 60.18,
 64.11, 145.12, 203.5a. See also free will
 wills, Bahá'í, 229, 307.9
 women: advancement of, 129.10,
 218.11, 219.4, 223.7, 224.5, 307, 331.17; in Africa, 116, 147.2; compilation on, 7.8, 307.3–4;
 participation in Bahá'í community,
 52.4a, 52.7, 52.8, 213.23, 307.5–7; prevention of violence against, 149; prophethood and, 7.8.
 See also the quality of women and men;
 office for the Advancement of
 women; Universal House of
 General Assembly
 87women: advancement of, (continued)
 justice, membership restricted to
 men
 word of God, 17.2–3, 60.6, 68.1–3,
 172.4, 205.7. See also Bahá'í
 Scriptures; Bible; Qur'án
 world bank, interfaith activities,
 331.20
 world civilization, 144.4, 145.7,
 203.6, 227.5. See also Bahá'í
 world commonwealth; world
 government
 world conference on education for
 All (UN), 90.5
 world conference on human rights
 (Vienna), 194.1
 world conference on religion and
 peace, 129.9
 world congress, first, 144.6
 world congress, second, 107.6,

129.20, 138.8, 145.20; message to, 144; plans for, 48.7, 64.9, 90.10; publicity for, 107 .2, 107 .5, 108.11e, 130.1; success of, 146, 151.1, 151.2

world f aiths d evelopment d ialogue, 331.20

world f orestry charter g athering, 90.5; message to, 82, 188

world government, 18.3, 31.5, 216.37, 356.7, 356.29a–30a

world h ealth o rganization (who), bic relations with, 64.3

world o rder of b ahá'u'lláh, 60.24, 129.2, 145.13; Administrative order as basis of, 201.13, 201.18–21a, 201.28, 250.3, 356.9; birth of, 8.1–2, 68.2, 108.2, 108.4; establishment of, 29.4–5b, 108.2, 145.16, 201.18–18b, 356.20a; g olden Age of, 55.4; puqúqu'lláh's importance to, 21.4–5, 345.3–4; influence of, 183.7, 227 .5, 355.6; Nineteen day feast and, 69.2, 69.6, 69.11; purpose of, 96.5a, 96.12, 129.15–16, 176.10; as solution to world problems, 109.2, 176.3; study of, 29.6, 85.3, 201.12–13; as theocracy, 337 .6–7; uhj's role in establishing, 255.10a; unfoldment of, 48.2–4, 145.16, 176.4–5, 201.11, 212.7, 356.4, 356.34a–38a. See also b ahá'í

commonwealth; b ahá'í w orld

commonwealth

World Order of Bahá'u'lláh, The (Shoghi e ffendi), 111.54

world Summit for Social d evelopment (copenhagen), 194.1, 200.2–3, 216.13

world w ar i, 356.24a, 356.32

world w ide f und for Nature (ww f), 42.1, 58, 64.3, 76.4, 129.9. See also Network on conservation and religion

world w ide w eb. See i nternet, the

worship, 44.3c, 60.24, 315.4, 315.7 .

See also d evotional meetings;

prayer

youth, b ahá'í: as children's class

teachers, 213.23, 218.12; dance workshops, 299.10; expansion and consolidation activities, 216.8, 222.13; in iran, 289.2–4;

martyrdoms of, 1.2, 5, 208.1b; messages to, 182, 208, 256, 338, 339, 346, 347; as role models, 338.5; service by, 22.7, 22.9, 141, 208.1b, 218.12, 235.1; Six year

plan activities, 129.11; spiritual

education of, 299.7; teaching work of, 200.4, 209.3; training institute involvement, 248.7–8, 256.3, 338.2, 347.2; as traveling teachers,

875g e n e r a l i n D e x

331.8. See also european bahá'í

youth council; junior youth, bahá'í

youth conference (vancouver), 339

youth f orum (canada), message to,

226

youth year of service, 129.11, 141.1–2,

141.6, 182.6yugoslavia: establishment of ISAs in,

98.1; teaching work in, 236.4

zaire, National Spiritual Assembly of,

reformation of, 22.9

zoroaster, visions of,

140.5c

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]